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Để làm được điều này, mình sẽ đọc cuốn sách này ít nhất lần/tuần

LỜI GIỚI THIỆU

Chào các bạn,

Các bạn đang cầm trên tay cuốn “Boost your vocabulary” được biên soạn bởi thầy Đình Thắng và team A&M IELTS.

Cuốn sách được viết nhằm mục đích giúp các bạn đang muốn cải thiện vốn từ vựng cho phần thi Reading trong IELTS. Sách được viết dựa trên nền tảng bộ Cambridge IELTS của Nhà xuất bản Đại học Cambridge – Anh Quốc.

Sau 07 năm phát hành miễn phí, cuốn sách đã giúp cho **31 bạn đạt 9.0** cùng rất nhiều bạn đã đạt mục tiêu cho phần thi IELTS Reading của mình. Không chỉ được sử dụng bởi đông đảo các bạn học sinh, sinh viên, người đi làm, cuốn sách còn được các thầy cô, các trung tâm tin tưởng lựa chọn làm giáo trình học viên của mình. Hơn thế, cuốn sách cũng được đông đảo các bạn bè quốc tế biết đến, tin tưởng và sử dụng.

Trong quá trình thực hiện, team A&M IELTS đã dành nhiều thời gian để nghiên cứu cách thức đưa nội dung sao cho khoa học và dễ dùng nhất với các bạn. Tuy vậy, cuốn sách không khỏi có những hạn chế nhất định. Mọi góp ý để cải thiện nội dung cuốn sách mọi người xin gửi về email amacademic.edu@gmail.com

Trân trọng cảm ơn,





TÁC GIẢ & NHÓM THỰC HIỆN

THẦY ĐÌNH THẮNG

- Là chủ nhiệm và Founder của A&M IELTS
- Giảng viên IELTS tại Hà Nội từ 2012
- Chứng chỉ ngành ngôn ngữ Anh, đại học Brighton, Anh Quốc, 2016.
- Diễn giả hội thảo IELTS tổ chức bởi IDP Việt Nam (2022)
- Tác giả các đầu sách IELTS như Hướng dẫn viết câu trong IELTS writing 7.0-7.5, Highlight academic phrases in examiners' essays, Boost your comprehension Cambridge IELTS



cùng các thầy cô và các thành viên trong team A&M IELTS ...



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HƯỚNG DẪN SỬ DỤNG SÁCH

ĐỐI TƯỢNG SỬ DỤNG SÁCH

Các bạn cần có mức độ từ vựng tương đương 5.5 trở lên (theo thang điểm 9 của IELTS), nếu không có thể sẽ gặp khó khăn trong việc sử dụng sách này.

CÁC BƯỚC SỬ DỤNG

CÁCH 1: LÀM TEST TRƯỚC, HỌC TỪ VỰNG SAU

Bước 1: Bạn in cuốn sách này ra. Nên in bìa màu để có thêm động lực học. Cuốn sách được thiết kế cho việc đọc trực tiếp, không phải cho việc đọc online nên bạn nào đọc online sẽ có thể thấy khá bất tiện khi tra cứu, đối chiếu từ vựng

Bước 2: Tìm mua cuốn Cambridge IELTS (10 cuốn mới nhất từ 8-17) của Nhà xuất bản Cambridge để làm. Hãy cẩn thận đừng mua nhầm sách lậu. Sách của nhà xuất bản Cambridge được tái bản tại Việt Nam thường có bìa và giấy dày, chữ rất rõ nét.

Bước 3: Làm một bài test hoặc passage bất kỳ trong bộ sách trên. Ví dụ passage 1, test 1 của Cambridge IELTS 13.

Bước 4: Đối chiếu với cuốn sách này, bạn sẽ lọc ra các từ vựng quan trọng cần học. Ví dụ passage 1, test 1 của Cambridge IELTS 13, bài về Tourism New Zealand Website: Bạn sẽ thấy

4.1 Cột bên trái là bản text gốc, trong đó bôi đậm các từ học thuật - academic word

4.2 Cột bên phải chứa các từ vựng này theo kèm định nghĩa (definition) hoặc từ đồng nghĩa (synonym)

CÁCH 2: HỌC TỪ VỰNG TRƯỚC, ĐỌC TEST SAU

Bước 1: Bạn in cuốn sách này ra. Nên in bìa màu để có thêm động lực học. Cuốn sách được thiết kế cho việc đọc trực tiếp, không phải cho việc đọc online nên bạn nào đọc online sẽ có thể thấy khá bất tiện khi tra cứu, đối chiếu từ vựng

Bước 2: Đọc cột bên trái như đọc báo. Duy trì hàng ngày. Khi nào không hiểu từ nào thì xem nghĩa hoặc synonym của từ đó ở cột bên phải. Giai đoạn này giúp bạn phát triển việc đọc tự nhiên, thay vì đọc theo kiểu làm test. Bạn càng hiểu nhiều càng tốt. Cố gắng nhớ từ theo ngữ cảnh.

Bước 3: Làm một bài test hoặc passage bất kỳ trong bộ sách Cambridge IELTS. Ví dụ bạn đọc xong cuốn Boost your vocabulary 9&10 này thì có thể làm các test trong cuốn 11 chẳng hạn. **Làm test xong thì cố gắng phát hiện các từ đã học** trong cuốn 9&10. Bạn nào có khả năng ghi nhớ tốt chắc chắn sẽ gặp lại rất nhiều từ đã học. Bạn nào có khả năng ghi nhớ vừa phải cũng sẽ gặp lại không ít từ.

Bước 4: Đọc cuốn Boost your vocabulary tương ứng với test bạn vừa làm.

Ví dụ 1 chu trình đầy đủ theo cách này

B1. Đọc hiểu và học từ vựng trong cuốn Boost your vocabulary 9&10

B2. Làm test 1 trong cuốn Boost your vocabulary 11

B3. Đọc hiểu và học từ vựng trong cuốn Boost your vocabulary 11 & tìm các từ lặp lại mà bạn đã đọc trong cuốn Boost your vocabulary 9&10



TEST 1

READING PASSAGE 1



The development of the London underground railway

In the first half of the 1800s, London's population grew at an **astonishing** rate, and the central area became increasingly **congested**. In addition, the **expansion** of the overground railway network resulted in more and more passengers arriving in the capital. However, in 1846, a Royal Commission decided that the railways should not be allowed to enter the City, the capital's historic and business centre. The result was that the overground railway **stations** formed a **ring** around the City. The area within consisted of poorly built, overcrowded **slums** and the streets were full of **horse-drawn** traffic. Crossing the City became a nightmare. It could take an hour and a half to travel 8 km by horse-drawn **carriage** or bus. **Numerous schemes** were

railway= a system of tracks that trains travel along
astonishing= surprising, shocking, astounding
congested= overcrowded, crammed, blocked
expansion= extension, growth, enlargement
station= a building and the surrounding area where buses or trains stop for people to get on or off
ring= circle, loop, sphere
slum= a very poor and crowded area, especially of a city
horse-drawn= a horse-drawn vehicle is pulled by a horse.

carriage= a vehicle with four wheels that is usually pulled by horses and was used mainly in the past
numerous= many, plentiful, various
scheme= plan, method, idea
propose= suggest, offer, recommend
resolve= solve, sort out, settle

proposed to **resolve** these problems, but few succeeded.

Amongst the most **vocal advocates** for a solution to London's traffic problems was Charles Pearson, who worked as a **solicitor** for the City of London. He saw both social and economic advantages in building an underground railway that would **link** the overground railway stations together and **clear** London slums at the same time. His idea was to **relocate** the poor workers who lived in the **inner-city** slums to newly **constructed suburbs**, and to provide cheap rail travel for them to get to work. Pearson's ideas gained support amongst some businessmen and in 1851 he **submitted** a plan to **Parliament**. It was **rejected**, but **coincided** with a **proposal** from another group for an underground connecting **line**, which Parliament **passed**.

The two groups **merged** and established the Metropolitan Railway Company in August 1854. The company's plan was to construct an underground railway line from the Great Western Railway's (GWR) station at Paddington to the edge of the City at Farringdon Street - a distance of almost 5 km. The organisation had difficulty in raising the funding for such a **radical** and expensive scheme, not least because of the **critical** articles printed by the **press**. **Objectors** argued that the **tunnels** would **collapse** under the weight of traffic overhead, buildings would be shaken and passengers would be **poisoned** by the **emissions** from the train **engines**. However, Pearson and his partners **persisted**.

The GWR, aware that the new line would finally enable them to run trains into the **heart** of the City, invested almost £250,000 in the scheme. **Eventually**, over a five-year period, £1m was **raised**. The chosen **route** ran beneath existing main roads to minimise the **expense** of **demolishing** buildings. **Originally scheduled** to be completed in 21 months, the construction of the underground line took three years. It was built just below street level using a technique known as 'cut and cover'. A **trench** about ten metres wide and six metres deep was dug, and the **sides**

vocal= outspoken, loud, forceful
advocate= supporter, promoter, activist
solicitor= a type of lawyer in Britain and Australia
link= connect, join, bring together
clear= tidy up, clear out, empty
relocate= move, displace, change place
inner-city= in the central part of a city where there are often problems because people are poor and there are few jobs and bad houses
construct= build, make, create
suburb= an area on the edge of a large town or city
submit= present, offer, suggest
parliament= the group of people who make the laws for their country
reject= refuse, decline, deny
coincide= happen together, overlap, match
proposal= suggestion, request, offer
line= a railway track
pass= accept, permit, approve

merge= combine, join together, team up
radical= extreme, far-out, progressive
critical= disapproving, fault-finding, unfavorable
press= media, newspapers, journalists
objector= opponent, skeptic, critic
tunnel= a long passage under or through the ground
collapse= breakdown, fall to pieces, fail
poison= harm, infect, injure
emission= exhaust fumes
engine= machine, piece of equipment, mechanism
persist= continue, carry on, stick with

heart= center, core, middle
eventually= finally, in the end, ultimately
raise= to raise money is to succeed in getting it
route= way, road, track
expense= cost, payment, expenditure
demolish= destroy, ruin, wreck
schedule= arrange, plan, organize
originally= firstly, in the beginning, initially

Trench= a narrow channel dug into the ground
side= a flat outer surface of an object, especially one that is not the top, the bottom, the front, or the back

temporarily held up with **timber beams**. Brick walls were then constructed, and finally a brick **arch** was added to create a tunnel. A two-metre-deep layer of soil was laid on top of the tunnel and the road above rebuilt.

The Metropolitan line, which opened on 10 January 1863, was the world's first underground railway. On its first day, almost 40,000 passengers were **carried** between Paddington and Farringdon, the journey taking about 18 minutes. By the end of the Metropolitan's first year of operation, 9.5 million journeys had been made.

Even as the Metropolitan began operation, the first **extensions** to the line were being **authorised**; these were built over the next five years, reaching Moorgate in the east of London and Hammersmith in the west. The original plan was to pull the trains with **steam locomotives**, using **firebricks** in the **boilers** to provide steam, but these engines were never **introduced**. Instead, the line used specially designed locomotives that were fitted with **water tanks** in which steam could be **condensed**. However, smoke and **fumes** remained a problem, even though **ventilation shafts** were added to the tunnels.

Despite the extension of the underground railway, by the 1880s, **congestion** on London's streets had become worse. The problem was partly that the existing underground lines formed a **circuit** around the centre of London and extended to the suburbs, but did not cross the capital's centre. The 'cut and cover' method of construction was not an option in this part of the capital. The only **alternative** was to **tunnel** deep underground.

Although the technology to create these tunnels existed, steam locomotives could not be used in such a **confined** space. It wasn't until the development of a **reliable** electric **motor**, and a **means** of transferring power from the **generator** to a moving train, that the world's first deep-level electric railway, the City & South London, became possible. The line opened in 1890, and ran from the City to Stockwell, south of the River Thames. The trains were made up of three **carriages** and driven by electric engines. The carriages were narrow and had tiny windows just below the roof

temporarily= in the short term, briefly, provisionally
beam= a long, thick piece of wood, metal, or concrete, especially used to support weight in a building or other structure
timber= wood, logs, kindling
arch= a structure, consisting of a curved top on two supports, that holds the weight of something above it

carry= transport, bring, transfer

extension= lengthening, expansion, increase
authorise= approve, permit, give permission
steam locomotive= a vehicle with an engine powered by steam, used for pulling trains
firebrick= a type of brick that is not damaged by high temperatures
boiler= a device that heats water
introduce= begin, launch, start
water tank= a large container for collecting and storing water
condense= to change or make something change from a gas to a liquid or solid state
fume= gas, smog, emission
ventilation= air circulation, freshening, airing
shaft= a long passage through a building or through the ground

congestion= overcrowding, jamming, blocking
circuit= route, path, track
alternative= another possibility, substitute, replacement
tunnel= dig, excavate, burrow

confined= small, cramped, enclosed
reliable= trustworthy, dependable, unfailing
motor= a device that changes electricity or fuel into movement and makes a machine work
means= way, method, measure
generator= power producer
carriage= any of the separate parts of a train in which the passengers sit

because it was thought that passengers would not want to look out at the tunnel walls. The line was not without its problems, mainly caused by an unreliable power supply. Although the City & South London Railway was a great **technical** achievement, it did not make a profit. Then, in 1900, the Central London Railway, known as the 'Tuppenny Tube', began operation using new electric locomotives. It was very popular and soon afterwards new railways and extensions were added to the growing **tube** network. By 1907, the heart of today's Underground system was **in place**.

technical= mechanical, industrial, scientific
tube= London's underground train system
in place=ready, ripe, primed

READING PASSAGE 2

Stadium: past, present and future

A.

Stadiums are among the oldest forms of urban **architecture**: **vast** stadiums where the public could watch sporting events were at the centre of western city life as far back as the ancient Greek and Roman **Empires**, well before the **construction** of the great **medieval cathedrals** and the **grand** 19th- and 20th-century railway **stations** which **dominated** urban **skylines** in later eras.

Today, however, stadiums are **regarded** with growing **scepticism**. Construction costs can **soar** above £1 billion, and stadiums finished for **major** events such as the Olympic Games or the FIFA World Cup have **notably fallen into** disuse and disrepair.

But this need not be **the case**. History shows that stadiums can **drive** urban development and **adapt** to the culture of every **age**. Even today, **architects** and planners are finding new ways to adapt the **mono-functional** sports **arenas** which became **emblematic** of

architecture= design, building, style
vast= huge, enormous, massive
empire= a group of countries ruled by a single person, government, or country
construction= building, creation, development
medieval= of or from the middle ages (= the period in the past from about 500 to 1500)
cathedral= a very large, usually stone, building for christian worship
grand= large, huge, massive
station= depot, terminal, stop
dominate= to be the largest or most noticeable part of something
skyline= the shape of objects against the sky, esp. buildings in a city

regard= think, consider, deem
scepticism= disbelief, doubt, uncertainty
soar= rise, escalate, rocket
major= most important, main, key
notably= especially, particularly, remarkably
fall into= to gradually get into a particular condition, especially to get into a bad condition

(not) the case= (not) true
drive= push, force, propel
adapt= fit, modify, adjust
age= period, time, era
architect= designer, engineer, builder
mono-functional= having a single function
arena= sports ground, stadium, pitch
emblematic= symbolic, representative, characteristic

modernisation during the 20th century.

- B. The amphitheatre* of Aries in southwest France, with a **capacity** of 25,000 **spectators**, is perhaps the best example of just how **versatile** stadiums can be. Built by the Romans in 90 AD, it became a **fortress** with four towers after the fifth century, and was then transformed into a village containing more than 200 houses. With the growing **interest** in **conservation** during the 19th century, it was **converted** back into an arena for the **staging** of bullfights, **thereby** returning the structure to its original use as a **venue** for public **spectacles**.

Another example is the **imposing** arena of Verona in northern Italy, with space for 30,000 spectators, which was built 60 years before the Aries amphitheatre and 40 years before Rome's famous Colosseum. It has **endured** the centuries and is currently considered one of the world's **prime** sites for opera, thanks to its **outstanding acoustics**.

- C. The area in the centre of the Italian town of Lucca, known as the Piazza dell'Anfiteatro, is yet another impressive example of an amphitheatre becoming **absorbed** into **the fabric of** the city. The site **evolved** in a similar way to Aries and was **progressively** filled with buildings from the Middle Ages until the 19th century, variously used as houses, a salt **depot** and a prison. But rather than reverting to an arena, it became a market square, designed by Romanticist architect Lorenzo Nottolini. Today, the **ruins** of the amphitheatre remain **embedded** in the various shops and **residences** surrounding the public square.

- D. There are many similarities between modern stadiums and the ancient amphitheatres **intended** for games. But some of the flexibility was lost at the beginning of the 20th century, as stadiums were developed using new products such as steel and **reinforced concrete**, and **made use of** bright lights for night-time matches.

Many such stadiums are situated in suburban areas, designed for sporting use only and surrounded by parking lots. These factors mean that they may not be as **accessible** to the **general public**, require more energy to run and contribute to urban heat.

capacity= volume, size, space
spectator= viewer, watcher, observer
versatile= flexible, adaptable, multipurpose
fortress= a large, strong building or group of buildings that can be defended from attack
interest= concern, attention, notice
conservation= protection, preservation, maintenance
convert= change, switch, alter
staging= performance, presentation, production
thereby= so, thus, in that way
venue= site, location, setting
spectacle= event, performance, display

imposing= impressive, striking, magnificent
endure= last, survive, persist
prime= excellent, first-rate, top-notch
outstanding= wonderful, excellent, exceptional
acoustic= sound, audio, auditory

absorb= incorporate, merge, integrate
the fabric of= the structure or parts of something
evolve= grow, progress, develop
progressively= gradually, little by little, with time
depot= storehouse, warehouse, storage area
ruin= debris, wreckage, remains
embed= incorporate, lodge, fix
residence= a home

intend= designate, aim, plan
reinforced concrete= concrete that contains metal rods to make it stronger
make use of= use, utilize, exploit

accessible= available, nearby, easy to get to
general public= population, citizens, ordinary people

- E. But many of today's most **innovative** architects see **scope** for the stadium to help improve the city. Among the current strategies, two seem to be having **particular** success: the stadium as an urban **hub**, and as a **power plant**.

There's a growing trend for stadiums to be **equipped** with public spaces and services that serve a function beyond sport, such as hotels, **retail outlets**, **conference** centres, restaurants and bars, children's playgrounds and green space. Creating mixed-use developments such as this **reinforces compactness** and multi-functionality, making more efficient use of land and helping to **regenerate** urban spaces.

This **opens** the space **up to** families and a wider **cross-section** of society, instead of **catering** only to **sportspeople** and **supporters**. There have been many examples of this in the UK: the mixed-use facilities at Wembley and Old Trafford have become a **blueprint** for many other stadiums in the world.

- F. The phenomenon of stadiums as power stations has **arisen from** the idea that energy problems can be overcome by **integrating interconnected** buildings **by means of** a smart **grid**, which is an electricity supply network that uses digital communications technology to **detect** and react to local changes in **usage**, without **significant** energy losses. Stadiums are ideal for these purposes, because their **canopies** have a large surface area for fitting **photovoltaic panels** and rise high enough (more than 40 metres) to make use of **micro** wind **turbines**.

Freiburg Mage Solar Stadium in Germany is the first of a new **wave** of stadiums as power plants, which also includes the Amsterdam Arena and the Kaohsiung Stadium. The latter, **inaugurated** in 2009, has 8,844 photovoltaic panels producing up to 1.14 GWh of electricity annually. This reduces the annual output of carbon dioxide by 660 tons and supplies up to 80 percent of the surrounding area when the stadium is not **in use**. This is **proof** that a stadium can serve its city, and have a **decidedly** positive impact in terms of reduction of CO₂ emissions.

innovative= modern, novel, groundbreaking
scope= opportunity, possibility, chance
particular= specific, exact, certain
hub= the central or main part of something where there is most activity
power plant= a factory where electricity is produced

equip= provide, give, furnish
retail outlet= a store that sells goods to the public
conference= meeting, seminar, discussion
reinforce= strengthen, bolster, support
compactness= neatness, smallness, trimness
regenerate= renew, redevelop, restart

open sth up to= to make something available
cross-section= representation, sample
cater= serve, provide for, accommodate
sportspeople= athlete, sports player
supporter= fan, follower, enthusiast
blueprint= prototype, example

arise from= stem from, result from, develop out of
integrate= mix, add, combine
interconnected= connected, joined, interrelated
by means of= by, via, using
grid= network, net, web
detect= discover, notice, identify
usage= the way something is treated or used
significant= large, big, sizable
canopy= top, covering, roof
photovoltaic= able to produce electricity from light
panel= board, pane, sheet
micro= very small
turbine= a type of machine through which liquid or gas flows and turns a special wheel with blades in order to produce power

wave= trend, tendency, movement
inaugurate= install, launch, initiate

in use= working, in operation, active
proof= evidence, confirmation, facts
decidedly= definitely, obviously, undoubtedly

central= vital, essential, key
era= period, time, age

G. Sporting arenas have always been **central** to the life and culture of cities. In every **era**, the stadium has **acquired** new value and uses: from **military** fortress to **residential** village, public space to theatre and most recently a **field** for **experimentation** in **advanced** engineering. The stadium of today now **brings together** multiple functions, thus helping cities to create a **sustainable** future.

* amphitheatre: (especially in Greek and Roman architecture) an open circular or oval building with a central space surrounded by tiers of seats for spectators, for the presentation of dramatic or sporting events

acquire= get, obtain, gain
military= armed, soldierly, fighting
residential= housing, inhabited, populated
field= ground, arena, pitch
experimentation= research, testing, investigation
advanced= developed, superior, sophisticated
bring together= combine, mix, gather
sustainable= maintainable, supportable, defensible

READING PASSAGE 3



Anna Keay reviews Charles Spencer's book about the **hunt** for King Charles II during the English Civil War of the seventeenth century

Charles Spencer's latest book, *To Catch a King*, tells us the story of the hunt for King Charles II in the six weeks after his **resounding defeat** at the Battle of Worcester in September 1651. And what a story it is. After his father was **executed** by the **Parliamentarians** in 1649, the young Charles II **sacrificed** one of the very **principles** his father had died for and did a **deal** with the Scots, **thereby** accepting Presbyterianism* as the national religion **in return for** being **crowned** King of Scots. His arrival in Edinburgh **prompted** the English Parliamentary **army** to **invade** Scotland in a **pre-emptive strike**. This was followed by a Scottish invasion of England. The two sides finally faced one another at Worcester in the west of England in 1651. After being **comprehensively** defeated on the **meadows** outside the city by the Parliamentary army, the 21-year-old king found himself the subject of a national manhunt, with a huge **sum** offered for his

hunt= pursuit, search, chase

resounding= very great
defeat= loss, setback, reverse # victory
execute= to kill someone as a legal punishment
Parliamentarian= a supporter of Parliament in the English Civil War; a Roundhead
sacrifice= give up, let go, lose
principle= value, standard, norm
deal= agreement, arrangement, transaction
thereby= so, thus, in that way
in return for= as an exchange for something
crown= to make someone officially a king or queen of a country
prompt= encourage, stimulate, provoke
army= military, defense force, soldiers
invade= attack, conquer, occupy
pre-emptive strike= a surprise attack that is launched in order to prevent the enemy from doing it to you

comprehensively= completely, totally
meadow= field, grazing land, pasture
sum= an amount of money

capture. Over the following six weeks he managed, through a series of heart-poundingly close **escapes**, to **evade** the Parliamentarians before seeking **refuge** in France. For the next nine years, the **penniless** and defeated Charles **wandered** around Europe with only a small group of loyal supporters.

Years later, after his **restoration** as king, the 50-year-old Charles II **requested** a meeting with the writer and **diarist** Samuel Pepys. His intention when asking Pepys to **commit his story to paper** was to ensure that this most extraordinary **episode** was never forgotten. Over two three-hour **sittings**, the king **related to** him in great detail his personal **recollections** of the six weeks he had spent as a **fugitive**. As the king and secretary **settled down** (a scene that is surely a gift for a future **scriptwriter**), Charles **commenced** his story: 'After the battle was so absolutely lost as to be beyond hope of recovery, I began to think of the best way of saving myself.

One of the joys of Spencer's book, a result not least of its use of Charles II's own **narrative** as well as those of his supporters, is just how close the reader gets to the action. The day-by-day retelling of the fugitives' **doings** provides **delicious** details: the cutting of the king's long hair with agricultural shears, the use of walnut leaves to **dye** his pale skin, and the day Charles spent lying on a branch of the great oak tree in Boscobel Wood as the Parliamentary soldiers **scoured** the forest floor below. Spencer **draws out** both the humour - such as the **preposterous** refusal of Charles's friend Henry Wilmot to adopt **disguise** on the grounds that it was **beneath his dignity** - and the emotional **tension** when the secret of the king's presence was **cautiously** revealed to his supporters.

Charles's adventures after losing the Battle of Worcester hide the uncomfortable truth that **whilst** almost everyone in England had been **appalled** by the **execution** of his father, they had not welcomed the arrival of his son with the Scots army, but had instead firmly **bolted** their doors. This was partly because he rode at the **head** of what looked like a foreign invasion force and partly because, after almost a decade of **civil war**, people were **desperate** to avoid it beginning again. This makes it all the more interesting that Charles II himself loved the story so much ever after. As well as retelling it to anyone who would listen, causing eye rolling among **courtiers**, he **set in train** a series of **initiatives** to **memorialise** it. There was to be a new order of **chivalry**, the Knights of the Royal Oak. A series of enormous oil paintings **depicting** the episode were produced, including a two-metre-wide **canvas** of Boscobel Wood and a set of six similarly

capture= arrest, seizure, imprisonment
escape= running away, getaway, breakout
evade= avoid, stay away from, steer clear
refuge= place of safety, protection, sanctuary
penniless= poor, impoverished, broke
wander= walk, stroll, roam

restoration= return, re-establishment, reinstatement
request= ask for, demand, invite
diarist= writer, biographer, journalist
commit sth to paper= to write something down
episode= event, incident, affair
sitting= meeting, session, appointment
relate= tell, speak about, narrate
recollection= memory, recall, reminiscence
fugitive= a person who is running away or hiding from the police or a dangerous situation
settle down= relax, calm down, slow down
scriptwriter= someone who writes stories for movies, television programs, etc
commence= begin, start, originate

narrative= description, story, tale
doings= someone's activities
delicious= enjoyable, pleasant, appealing
dye= change the color of, tint, color
scour= to search a place or thing very carefully in order to try to find something
draw out= lengthen, make last, prolong
preposterous= silly, laughable, ridiculous
disguise= mask, camouflage, concealment
beneath your dignity= If something is beneath your dignity, you feel that you are too important to do it
tension= pressure, tightness, stiffness
cautiously= with care, carefully, watchfully

whilst= while, whereas, although
appalled= shocked, horrified, disgusted
execution= the death sentence, killing, putting to death
bolt= fasten, lock, secure
head= top, peak, summit
civil war= a war fought by different groups of people living in the same country
desperate= determined, eager, in urgent need
courtier= a companion of a queen, king, or other ruler in their official home
set in train= to start a process
initiative= plan, scheme, programme
memorialise= honor, celebrate, remember
chivalry= the system of behaviour followed by knights in the medieval period
depict= portray, illustrate, represent
canvas= strong, rough cloth used for painting

enormous paintings of the king **on the run**. In 1660, Charles II **commissioned** the artist John Michael Wright to paint a flying **squadron** of cherubs* carrying an oak tree to the heavens on the ceiling of his **bedchamber**. It is hard to imagine many other kings marking the lowest point in their life so enthusiastically, or indeed **pulling off** such an escape in the first place.

Charles Spencer is the perfect person to **pass the story on** to a new generation. His **pacey**, readable **prose steers deftly clear of** modern idioms and elegantly brings to life the details of the great tale. He has **even-handed** sympathy for both the **fugitive** king and the **fierce** republican **regime** that hunted him, and he succeeds in his desire to explore far more of the background of the story than previous books on the subject have done. Indeed, the opening third of the book is about how Charles II found himself at Worcester in the first place, which for some will be reason alone to read *To Catch a King*.

The **tantalising** question left, in the end, is that of what it all meant. Would Charles II have been a different king had these six weeks never happened? The days and nights spent in hiding must have affected him in some way. Did the need to **assume** disguises, to survive on wit and charm alone, to use **trickery** and **subterfuge** to escape from tight corners help form him? This is the one area where the book doesn't quite hit the **mark**. Instead its depiction of Charles II in his final years as an ineffective, pleasure-loving **monarch** doesn't **do justice to** the man (neither is it accurate), or to the complexity of his character. But this one **niggle** aside, *To Catch a King* is an excellent **read**, and those who come to it knowing little of the famous tale will find they have a **treat** in store.

- Presbyterianism: part of the reformed Protestant religion
- Cherub: an image of angelic children used in paintings

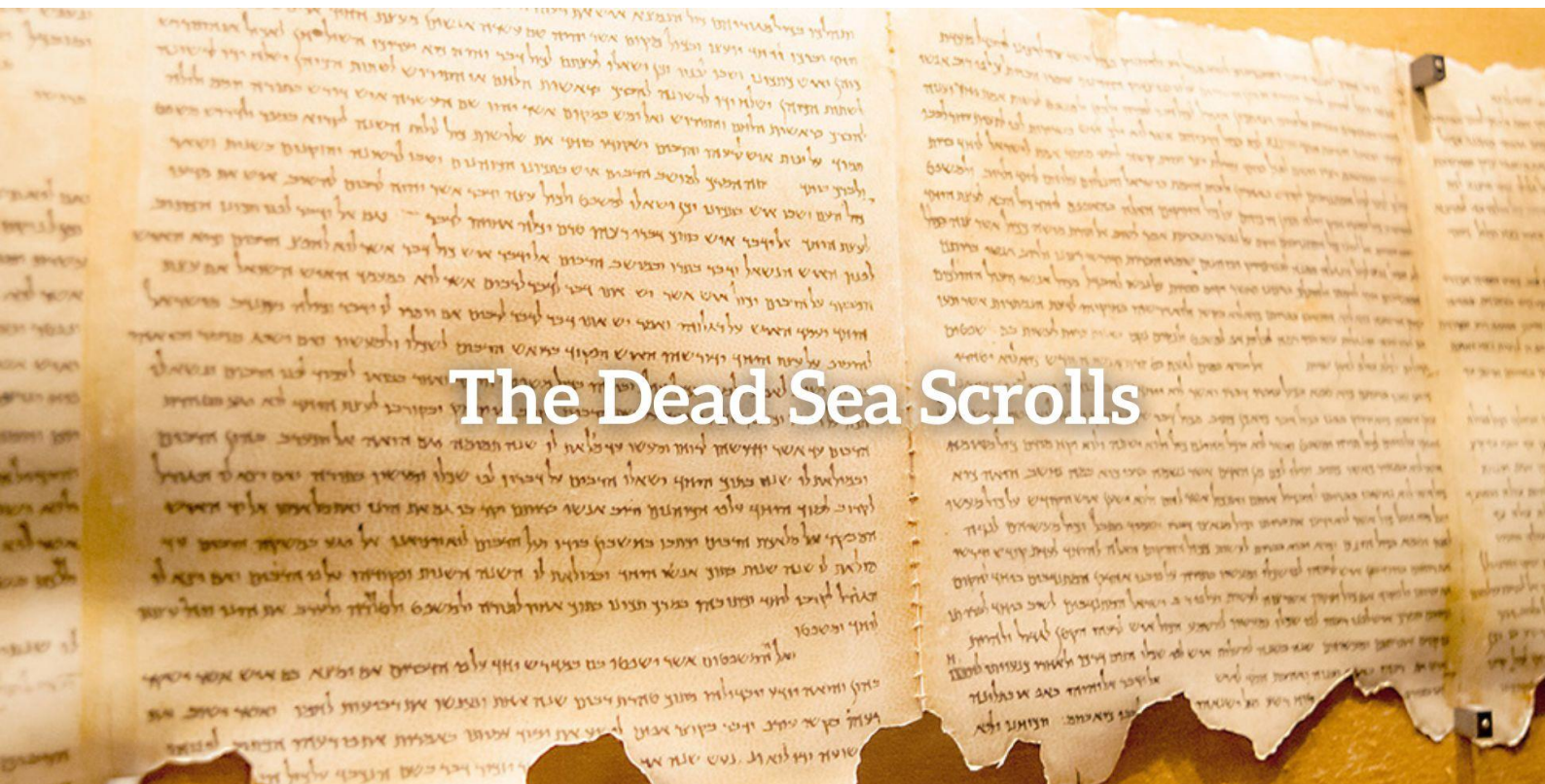
on the run= running, fleeing, escaping
commission= order, assign, appoint
squadron= a military force consisting of a group of aircraft or ships
bedchamber= a bedroom
pull off= to succeed in doing something difficult or unexpected:

pass sth on= hand sth down, retell, continue
pacey= fast-paced, action-packed
prose= writing style, text, style
steers clear of= avoid, omit, reject
deftly= skillfully, cleverly, smartly
even-handed= fair, balanced, impartial
fugitive= escapee, runaway, absconder
fierce= violent, aggressive, brutal
regime= government, administration, management

tantalising= exciting, alluring, provoking
assume= use, adopt, acquire
trickery= dishonesty, fraud, deception
subterfuge= trick, deception, artifice
mark= an intended result or an object aimed at
monarch= ruler, king, queen
do justice to sb/sth= to treat someone or something in a way that is fair and shows their or its true qualities
niggle= doubt, worry, concern
read= the act of reading something
treat= delight, fun, pleasure

Test 2

READING PASSAGE 1



The Dead Sea Scrolls

In late 1946 or early 1947, three Bedouin teenagers were **tending** their goats and sheep near the **ancient settlement** of Qumran, **located** on the northwest shore of the Dead Sea in what is now known as the West Bank. One of these young **shepherds** **tossed** a rock into an **opening** on the side of a cliff and was surprised to hear a **shattering** sound. He and his **companions** later entered the cave and **stumbled across** a collection of large clay jars, seven of which **contained scrolls** with writing on them. The teenagers took the seven scrolls to a nearby town where they were sold for a small **sum** to a local **antiquities dealer**. **Word of the find spread**, and Bedouins and **archaeologists** **eventually unearthed** tens of thousands of additional scroll **fragments** from 10 nearby caves; together they **make up** between 800 and 900 manuscripts. It soon became clear that this

tend= manage, watch, supervise
ancient= outdate, old-fashioned, antiquated
settlement= community, society, village
locate= place, situate, position
shepherd= sheep herder, sheepmen, sheepwomen
toss= throw, pitch, lob
opening= gap, hole, notch
shattering= crushing, smashing, wrecking
companion= friend, colleague acquaintance
stumble across = find, discover, come across
contain= include, surround, comprise
scroll= manuscript, document, copy
sum= a particular amount of money
antiquity= relic, antique, artefact
dealer= trader, seller, wholesaler
spread the word= to communicate a message to a lot of people
archaeologist= someone who studies the buildings, graves, tools, and other objects of people who lived in the past
eventually= finally, ultimately, sooner or later
unearth= uncover, discover, reveal
fragment= piece, portion, part
make up= form, comprise, constitute

was one of the greatest archaeological discoveries ever made.

The **origin** of the Dead Sea Scrolls, which were written around 2,000 years ago between 150 BCE and 70 CE, is still the subject of **scholarly debate** even today. According to the **prevailing** theory, they are the **work** of a population that **inhabited** the area until Roman **troops** destroyed the settlement around 70 CE. The area was known as Judea at that time, and the people are thought to have belonged to a group called the Essenes, a **devout** Jewish **sect**.

The majority of the texts on the Dead Sea Scrolls are in Hebrew, with some **fragments** written in an ancient version of its alphabet thought to have **fallen out of** use in the fifth century BCE. But there are other languages as well. Some scrolls are in Aramaic, the language spoken by many **inhabitants** of the region from the sixth century BCE to the **siege** of Jerusalem in 70 CE. In addition, several texts **feature translations** of the Hebrew Bible into Greek.

The Dead Sea Scrolls include fragments from every book of the Old Testament of the Bible except for the Book of Esther. The only entire book of the Hebrew Bible **preserved** among the manuscripts from Qumran is Isaiah; this copy, **dated to** the first century BCE, is considered the earliest **biblical** manuscript still in existence. Along with biblical texts, the scrolls include documents about **sectarian regulations** and religious **writings** that do not appear in the Old Testament.

The writing on the Dead Sea Scrolls is mostly in black or **occasionally** red ink, and the scrolls themselves are nearly all made of either parchment (animal skin) or an early form of paper called 'papyrus'. The only **exception** is the scroll numbered 3Q15, which was created out of a combination of copper and tin. Known as the Copper Scroll, this **curious** document features letters **chiselled** onto metal - perhaps, as some have **theorized**, to better **withstand the passage of time**. One of the most **intriguing** manuscripts from Qumran, this is a sort of ancient treasure map that lists dozens of gold and silver **caches**. Using an **unconventional** vocabulary and odd spelling, it describes 64 underground hiding places that **supposedly** contain **riches** buried for **safekeeping**. None of these **hoards** have been recovered, possibly because the Romans **pillaged** Judea during the first century CE. According

origin= used to describe the particular way in which something started to exist
manuscript= copy, text, document
scholarly= relating to serious study of a particular subject
debate= discussion, argument, dispute
prevailing= current, existing,
inhabit= occupy, settle, dwell
work= production, creation
troop= soldiers or armed forces.
devout= sincere, honest, earnest
sect= a group of people with their own particular set of beliefs and practices, especially within or separated from a larger religious group

fragment= piece, part
fall out of= to be used no longer
inhabitant= resident, occupant, dweller
siege= blockade, barrier, obstruction
feature= include, highlight, appear
translation= interpretation, rendition, change

preserve= conserve, maintain, sustain
date to= establish or ascertain the date of (an object or event).
biblical= the holy book of the Christian religion
sectarian= religious, rigid, sectional
regulation= rule, instruction, guideline
writing= text, script, inscription

occasionally= infrequently, uncommonly, seldom
exception= exclusion, omission, allowance
combination= arrangement, understanding, permutation
curious= odd, strange, unusual
chisel= carve, shape, mold
theorize= hypothesize, conjecture, imagine
withstand= endure, survive, resist
the passage of time= the passing of time

intriguing= fascinating, interesting, exciting
cache= supply, accumulation, collection
unconventional= strange, unusual, odd
supposedly= allegedly, evidently, apparently
rich= material, asset, resource
safekeeping= protection, charge, security
hoard= pile, store, supply
pillage= if soldiers pillage a place in a war, they steal a lot of things and do a lot of damage

to various **hypotheses**, the treasure belonged to local people, or was **rescued** from the Second Temple before its destruction or never existed to begin with.

Some of the Dead Sea Scrolls have been on interesting journeys. In 1948, a Syrian Orthodox **archbishop** known as Mar Samuel **acquired** four of the original seven scrolls from a Jerusalem shoemaker and part-time **antiquity dealer**, paying less than \$100 for them. He then travelled to the United States and unsuccessfully offered them to a number of universities, including Yale. Finally, in 1954, he placed an advertisement in the business newspaper *The Wall Street Journal* - under the category '**Miscellaneous** Items for Sale' - that **read**: 'Biblical Manuscripts dating back to at least 200 B.C. are for sale. This would be an ideal gift to an educational or religious **institution** by an individual or group.' Fortunately, Israeli archaeologist and **statesman** Yigael Yadin **negotiated** their purchase and brought the scrolls back to Jerusalem, where they remain to this day.

In 2017, researchers from the University of Haifa restored and **deciphered** one of the last untranslated scrolls. The university's Eshbal Ratson and Jonathan Ben-Dov spent one year **reassembling** the 60 fragments that make up the scroll. Deciphered from a band of coded text on parchment, the **find** provides **insight** into the community of people who wrote it and the 364-day calendar they would have used. The scroll names celebrations that **indicate** shifts in seasons and details two yearly religious events known from another Dead Sea Scroll. Only one more known **scroll** remains untranslated.

hypothesis= theory, premise, suggestion
rescue= save, free, liberate

archbishop= a priest of the highest rank, who is in charge of all the churches in a particular area
acquire= get, gain, obtain
antiquity dealer= a person engaged in the business of selling antiques

miscellaneous= various, assorted, diverse
read= state, say, announce
institution= organization, establishment, association
statesman= a political or government leader, especially one who is respected as being wise and fair
negotiate= discuss, reach a deal, bargain

decipher= to change a message written in a code into ordinary language so that you can read it
reassemble= reconvene, reunite, congregate
find= discovery, invention
insight= vision, understanding
indicate= show, specify, direct

READING PASSAGE 2

A second attempt at domesticating the tomato

It took at least 3,000 years for humans to learn how to **domesticate** the wild tomato and **cultivate** it for food. Now two separate teams in Brazil and China have done it all over again in less than three years. And they have done it better in some ways, as the re-domesticated tomatoes are more **nutritious** than the ones we eat at present.

This **approach** relies on the **revolutionary** CRISPR **genome** editing technique, in which changes are **deliberately** made to the DNA of a living **cell**, allowing **genetic material** to be added, removed or **altered**. The technique could not only improve existing crops, but could also be used to turn thousands of wild plants into useful and **appealing** foods. In fact, a third team in the US has already begun to do this with a relative of the tomato called the groundcherry.

domesticate=tame, control, houstrain
cultivate= nurture, farm, grow
nutritious= healthy, healthful, nourishing

approach= method, technique, tactic
rely on= depend on, count on, bank on
revolutionary= groundbreaking, innovative, progressive

genome= all the genes in one type of living thing → DNA
deliberately= consciously thoughtfully, purposely
cell= the smallest part of a living thing that can exist independently
genetic= relating to genes or genetics
material= substance, item, object
alter= modify, change, adjust
appealing= attractive, tempting, alluring

This **fast-track domestication** could help make the world's food supply healthier and far more **resistant** to diseases, such as the **rust fungus devastating** wheat crops.

'This could **transform** what we eat,' says Jorg Kudla at the University of Munster in Germany, a member of the Brazilian team. 'There are 50,000 **edible** plants in the world but 90 percent of our energy comes from just 15 crops.'

'We can now **mimic** the known domestication **course** of major crops like rice, **maize, sorghum** or others,' says Caixia Gao of the Chinese Academy of Sciences in Beijing. 'Then we might try to domesticate plants that have never been domesticated.'

B. Wild tomatoes, which are **native to** the Andes region in South America, produce pea sized fruits. Over many generations, peoples such as the Aztecs and Incas transformed the plant by selecting and **breeding** plants with mutations* in their genetic structure, which resulted in **desirable traits** such as larger fruit.

But every time a single plant with a mutation is taken from a larger **population** for breeding, much genetic **diversity** is lost. And sometimes the desirable mutations come with less **desirable** traits. For instance, the tomato **strains** grown for supermarkets have lost much of their flavour.

By comparing the genomes of modern plants to those of their wild relatives, **biologists** have been **working out** what genetic changes **occurred** as plants were domesticated. The teams in Brazil and China have now used this knowledge to **reintroduce** these changes **from scratch** while **maintaining** or even **enhancing** the desirable traits of wild strains.

C. Kudla's team made six changesaltogether. For instance, they **tripled** the size of fruit by editing a gene called FRUIT WEIGHT, and increased the number of tomatoes per **truss** by editing another called MULTIFLORA.

While the **historical** domestication of tomatoes reduced levels of the red **pigment** lycopene - thought to have **potential** health benefits - the team in Brazil **managed to boost** it instead. The wild tomato has

fast-track= happening or making progress more quickly than is usual
domestication= housetraining, taming
resistant= resilient, tolerant, unaffected
rust= a plant disease that causes reddish-brown spots
fungus= mushroom, mold
devastate= destroy, damage, harm

edible= something that is edible can be eaten
transform= change, alter, convert

mimic= imitate, impersonate, take off
maize= corn
sorghum= a type of grain that is grown in tropical areas
course= the often gradual development of something

native to= refer to plants and animals that grow naturally in a place
breed= raise, farm, produce
desirable= wanted, looked-for, worthy
trait= characteristic, feature, mannerism

population= all the people or animals of a particular type who live in one place
diversity= variety, assortment, mixture
desirable= wanted, needed, attractive
strain= an animal or plant from a particular group whose characteristics are different from others

biologist= natural scientist, environmentalist, ecologist
work out= solve, figure out, understand
occur= happen, take place, arise
reintroduce= reestablish, reinstate, bring back
from scratch= if you start something from scratch, you begin it without using anything that existed or was prepared before
maintain= keep up, sustain, continue
enhance= improve, develop, advance

triple= to make something increase three times in size
truss= the stem that carries the flowers, which turn into tomatoes

historical= ancient, antique, old
pigment= color, coloring, tone
potential= possible, ability, probable
manage to= to succeed in doing or dealing with something, especially something difficult
boost= enhance, increase, improve

twice as much **lycopene** as **cultivated** ones; the newly domesticated one has five times as much.

'They are quite tasty,' says Kudla. 'A little bit **strong**. And very **aromatic**.'

The team in China re-domesticated several strains of wild tomatoes with desirable traits lost in domesticated tomatoes. In this way they managed to create a strain resistant to a common disease called **bacterial** spot race, which can **devastate** **yields**. They also created another strain that is more salt **tolerant** - and has higher levels of vitamin C.

D. Meanwhile, Joyce Van Eck at the Boyce Thompson Institute in New York state decided to use the same approach to domesticate the groundcherry or goldenberry (*Physalis pruinosa*) for the first time. This fruit looks similar to the closely related Cape gooseberry (*Physalis peruviana*).

Groundcherries are already sold to a **limited extent** in the US but they are hard to produce because the plant has a **sprawling** growth habit and the small fruits fall off the branches when **ripe**. Van Eck's team has edited the plants to increase fruit size, make their growth more **compact** and to stop fruits dropping. 'There's potential for this to be a **commercial** crop,' says Van Eck. But she adds that taking the work further would be expensive because of the need to pay for a **licence** for the CRISPR technology and get **regulatory approval**.

E. This approach could boost the use of many **obscure** plants, says Jonathan Jones of the Sainsbury Lab in the UK. But it will be hard for new foods to grow so popular with farmers and consumers that they become new **staple** crops, he thinks.

The three teams already **have their eye on** other plants that could be '**catapulted** into the **mainstream**', including foxtail, oat-grass and cowpea. By choosing wild plants that are **drought** or heat tolerant, says Gao, we could create crops that will **thrive** even as the planet warms. But Kudla didn't want to **reveal** which species were in his team's sights, because CRISPR has made the process so easy. 'Any one with the right skills could go to their lab and do this.'

**mutations: changes in an organism's genetic structure that can be passed down to later generations*

lycopene= a red carotenoid pigment present in tomatoes and many berries and fruits.

cultivate= nurture, farm, grow

strong= great, intense, extreme

aromatic= fragrant, sweet-smelling, perfumed

bacterial= very small living things, some of which cause illness or disease

devastate= destroy, demolish, ruin

yield= harvest, crop

tolerant= to continue existing despite bad or difficult conditions

limited= incomplete, partial, restricted

extent= degree, level, amount

sprawling= extensive, expansive, spreading

ripe= full-grown, mature

compact= dense, solid, compressed

commercial= profitable, money making, viable

licence= permission, authority, right

regulatory= relating to the activity of checking whether a business is working according to official rules or laws

approval= official permission

obscure= unknown, unseen, strange

staple= a basic food

have sb's eye on= to have seen something that you want and intend to get

be catapulted into something= to suddenly experience a particular state, such as being famous

mainstream= a common thing

drought= a long period of dry weather when there is not enough water for plants and animals to live

thrive= flourish, prosper, succeed

reveal= disclose, expose, uncover

READING PASSAGE 3



Insight or evolution?

Two scientists consider the **origins** of **discoveries** and other **innovative** behavior

Scientific discovery is popularly believed to **result from** the **sheer genius** of such **intellectual** stars as **naturalist** Charles Darwin and **theoretical physicist** Albert Einstein. Our view of such **unique contributions** to science often **disregards** the person's **prior** experience and the efforts of their **lesser-known predecessors**. **Conventional wisdom** also **places great weight on insight** in **promoting breakthrough** scientific achievements, as if ideas **spontaneously pop** into someone's head - fully formed and **functional**.

There may be some limited truth to this view. However, we believe that it largely **misrepresents** the real **nature** of scientific discovery, as well as that of creativity and innovation in many other **realms** of human **endeavor**.

origin= root, background, foundation
discovery= detection, finding, outcome
innovative= creative, inventive, pioneering

result from= be caused by, arise from, originate from
sheer= pure, absolute, complete
genius= mastermind, brilliance, outstanding ability
intellectual= intelligent, scholarly, knowledgeable
naturalist= biologist, botanist, natural scientist
theoretical= hypothetical, academic, abstract
physicist= a scientist who has special knowledge and training in physics
unique= exclusive, exceptional, only one of its kind
contribution= influence, role, involvement
disregard= ignore, disrespect, neglect
prior= previous, preceding, past
lesser-known= less popular
predecessor= something that comes before another thing in time
conventional= usual, normal, typical
wisdom= understanding, knowledge, sense
place emphasis, importance, etc. on something= highlight, value, stress
weight= importance, significance, meaning
insight= vision, awareness, intuition
promote= stimulate, foster, encourage
breakthrough= pivotal, central, important
spontaneously= impulsively, suddenly, naturally
pop into one's head= suddenly have an idea
functional= useful, practical, purposeful
misrepresent= not tell the truth, pretend, lie
nature= quality, features, character
realm= field, area, domain
endeavor= attempt, effort, try

Setting aside such greats as Darwin and Einstein - whose **monumental** contributions are **duly** celebrated - we suggest that innovation is more a process of trial and error, where two steps forward may sometimes come with one step back, as well as one or more steps to the right or left. This evolutionary view of human innovation **undermines** the **notion** of creative genius and recognizes the **cumulative** nature of scientific progress.

Consider one **unheralded** scientist: John Nicholson, a mathematical physicist working in the 1910s who **postulated** the existence of 'proto-elements' in outer space. By combining different numbers of weights of these proto-elements' **atoms**, Nicholson could recover the weights of all the elements in the then-known **periodic table**. These successes are all the more (even more) **noteworthy** given the fact that Nicholson was wrong about the presence of proto-elements: they do not actually exist. Yet, amid his often **fanciful** theories and **wild speculations**, Nicholson also proposed a novel theory about the structure of atoms. Niels Bohr, the Nobel prize-winning **father of** modern atomic theory, jumped off from this interesting idea to **conceive** his now-famous model of the atom.

What are we **to make of** this story? One might simply conclude that science is a **collective** and cumulative **enterprise**. That may be true, but there may be a deeper insight to be **gleaned**. We propose that science is **constantly** evolving, much as species of animals do. In biological systems, **organisms** may display new characteristics that result from random genetic mutations. In the same way, random, **arbitrary** or accidental mutations of ideas may help **pave the way for advances** in science. If mutations prove beneficial, then the animal or the scientific theory will continue to **thrive** and perhaps **reproduce**.

Support for this **evolutionary** view of behavioral innovation comes from many **domains**. Consider one example of an **influential** innovation in US horseracing. The so-called 'acey-deucey' **stirrup** placement, in which the rider's foot in his left stirrup is placed as much as 25 centimeters lower than the right, is believed to **confer** important speed advantages when turning on oval tracks. It was developed by a relatively unknown jockey named Jackie Westrope. Had Westrope **conducted** **methodical investigations** or examined **extensive** film records in a **shrewd** plan to **outrun** his rivals? Had he **foreseen** the speed advantage that would be

set aside= to ignore or not think about a particular fact or situation while considering a matter
monumental= colossal, massive, gigantic.
duly= accordingly, suitably, appropriately
undermine= weaken, destabilize, threaten
notion= belief, concept, perception
cumulative= aggregate, accumulative, growing

unheralded= not known about or recognized as good
postulate= hypothesize, assume, theorize
proto= first, especially from which other similar things develop; original
atom= particle, subdivision, element
periodic table= a list of the symbols of all the chemical elements arranged in rows and columns down a page
noteworthy= notable, striking, remarkable
fanciful= imaginary, make-believe, fictional
wild speculation= something that you say that is not based on facts and is probably wrong
the father of= someone who began, or first made something important
conceive= create, invent, form

make something of something/someone= to have an impression or an understanding about something
collective= cooperative, communal, joint
enterprise= a large project
glean= pick up, gather, collect
constantly= continually, continuously, regularly
organism= creature, being, living things
arbitrary= random, chance, haphazard
pave the way for= to make it possible for someone to do something or for something to happen
advance= development, growth, expansion
thrive= flourish, prosper, grow
reproduce= to produce a copy of something

evolutionary= involving a gradual process of change and development
domain= area, field
influential= powerful, important, significant
stirrup= one of a pair of pieces that hang from the side of a horse's saddle, used for resting your foot when you are riding
confer= give, provide, grant
conduct= do, perform, carry out
methodical= logical, systematic
investigation= study, examination, exploration
extensive= wide, large-scale, wide-ranging
shrewd= wise, cunning, clever
outrun= run faster than, beat, overtake
foresee= predict, forecast, anticipate

conferred by riding acey-deucy? No. He suffered a leg injury, which left him unable to fully bend his left knee. His **modification** just happened to **coincide** with enhanced left-hand turning performance. This led to the rapid and widespread **adoption** of riding acey-deucy by many riders, a racing style that continues in today's **thoroughbred** racing.

Plenty of other stories show that fresh advances can arise from error, **misadventure**, and also pure **serendipity** - a happy accident. For example, in the early 1970s, two employees of the company 3M each had a problem: Spencer Silver had a product - a glue which was only slightly sticky - and no use for it, while his colleague Art Fry was trying to figure out how to **affix** temporary bookmarks in his hymn book without damaging its pages. The solution to both these problems was the invention of the brilliantly simple yet **phenomenally** successful Post-It note. Such examples **give lie to** the claim that **ingenious**, **designing** minds are responsible for human creativity and invention. Far more **banal** and **mechanical** forces may be at work; forces that are **fundamentally** connected to the laws of science.

The notions of insight, creativity and genius are often **invoked**, but they remain **vague** and of doubtful scientific utility, especially when one considers the diverse and enduring contributions of individuals such as Plato, Leonardo da Vinci, Shakespeare, Beethoven, Galileo, Newton, Kepler, Curie, Pasteur and Edison. These notions **merely** label rather than explain the evolution of human innovations. We need another approach, and there is a promising candidate.

The Law of Effect was **advanced** by **psychologist** Edward Thorndike in 1898, some 40 years after Charles Darwin published his **groundbreaking** work on biological evolution, *On the Origin of Species*. This simple law **holds** that organisms tend to repeat successful behaviors and to **refrain** from performing unsuccessful ones. Just like Darwin's Law of Natural Selection, the Law of Effect involves an entirely mechanical process of variation and selection, without any end **objective** in sight.

Of course, the origin of human innovation demands much further study. In **particular**, the **provenance** of the raw material on which the Law of Effect **operates** is not as clearly known as that of the genetic mutations on which the Law of Natural Selection operates. The generation of novel ideas and behaviors may not be entirely random, but

modification= alteration, adjustment, change
coincide= happen together overlap, match
adoption= accepting or starting to use something new
thoroughbred= (animals) with parents that are of the same breed and have good qualities

misadventure= accident, misfortune, mishap
serendipity= luck, chance, fate
affix= stick, fasten, attach
phenomenally= remarkably, unusually, oddly
give the lie to= to prove that something is not true
ingenious= clever, resourceful, inventive
designing= used to describe someone who tries to get what they want, usually dishonestly
banal= boring, ordinary, not original
mechanical= without thinking about what you are doing, esp. because you do it often-repetitive
fundamentally= basically, essentially, primarily

invoke= mention, refer, quote
vague= unclear, abstracted, dreamy
merely= simply, just, only

advance= to suggest an idea or theory
psychologist = someone who is trained in psychology
groundbreaking= revolutionary, innovative, advanced
hold= to state that something is true
refrain= avoid doing, cease, hold back
refrain= desist, abstain, renounce
objective= purpose, goal, intention

particular= specific, precise, exact
provenance= origin, background, birth place
operate= work, conduct, carry out

constrained by prior successes and failures - of the current individual (such as Bohr) or of predecessors (such as Nicholson).
The time seems right for **abandoning** the **naive notions** of intelligent design and genius, and for scientifically exploring the true origins of creative behavior.

constrain= restrain, restrict, control
abandon= end, leaving, cancel
naive= simple, childlike, innocent
notion= idea, view, concept

Test 3

READING PASSAGE 1



The thylacine

The **extinct** thylacine, also known as the Tasmanian tiger, was a marsupial* that **bore a superficial resemblance** to a dog. Its most **distinguishing feature** was the 13- 19 dark brown **stripes** over its back, beginning at the **rear** of the body and **extending** onto the tail. The thylacine's average nose to-tail length for adult males was 162.6 cm, compared to 153.7 cm for females.

The thylacine appeared to **occupy** most types of **terrain** except **dense rainforest**, with open **eucalyptus** forest thought to be its **prime** habitat. In terms of feeding, it was **exclusively carnivorous**, and its stomach was **muscular** with an ability to

extinct= died out, wiped out, nonexistent
superficial= external, exterior, apparent
bore a resemblance= to look a lot like someone else
distinguishing= unique, distinctive, differentiating
feature= characteristic, trait, attribute
stripe= line, strip, bar
rear= at the back of something
extend= continue, reach, go on

occupy= inhabit, live in, dwell in
terrain= land, topography, ground
dense= thick, concentrated, compact
rainforest= a tropical forest with tall trees that are very close together, growing in an area where it rains a lot
eucalyptus= a tall tree that produces an oil with a strong smell, used in medicines
prime= main, primary
exclusively= solely, wholly, uniquely
carnivorous= meat-eating, flesh-eating
muscular= strong, powerful

distend so that it could eat large amounts of food at one time, probably an **adaptation** to **compensate** for long periods when hunting was unsuccessful and food **scarce**. The thylacine was not a fast runner and probably caught its **prey** by **exhausting** it during a long **pursuit**. During long-distance chases, thylacines were likely to have relied more on scent than any other sense. They **emerged** to hunt during the evening, night and early morning and tended to **retreat** to the hills and forest for shelter during the day. Despite the common name 'tiger', the thylacine had a shy, nervous **temperament**. Although mainly **nocturnal**, it was sighted moving during the day and some individuals were even recorded **basking** in the sun.

The thylacine had an extended breeding season from winter to spring, with **indications** that some breeding took place **throughout** the year. The thylacine, like all marsupials, was tiny and hairless when born. Newborns crawled into the **pouch** on the belly of their mother, and attached themselves to one of the four **teats**, remaining there for up to three months. When old enough to leave the pouch, the young stayed in a **lair** such as a deep rocky cave, well-hidden nest or **hollow** log, **whilst** the mother hunted.

Approximately 4,000 years ago, the thylacine was **widespread** throughout New Guinea and most of **mainland** Australia, as well as the island of Tasmania. The most recent, **well-dated occurrence** of a thylacine on the mainland is a carbon-dated **fossil** from Murray Cave in Western Australia, which is around 3,100 years old. Its **extinction coincided** closely with the arrival of wild dogs called dingoes in Australia and a similar **predator** in New Guinea. Dingoes never reached Tasmania, and most scientists see this as the main reason for the thylacine's survival there.

The **dramatic** decline of the thylacine in Tasmania, which began in the 1830s and continued for a century, is generally **attributed to** the **relentless** efforts of sheep farmers and bounty hunters** with shotguns. While this determined campaign **undoubtedly** played

distend= swell up, expand, enlarge
adaptation= adjustment, modification, change
compensate= balance, pay off, offset
scarce= rare, limited, inadequate
prey= an animal that is hunted and killed for food by another animal:
exhaust= tire, drain, weaken
pursuit= chase, hunt, track down
emerge= appear, come out, come into view
retreat= go back, retire, hide
temperament= nature, character, personality
nocturnal= active at night
bask= to lie or sit enjoying the warmth especially of the sun

indication= hint, sign, suggestion
throughout= all over, during, all the way through
pouch= a pocket of skin on the stomach which marsupials such as kangaroos use for carrying their babies
teat= one of the small parts on a female animal's body that her babies suck milk from
lair= the place where a wild animal hides and sleeps
hollow= empty, unfilled, unoccupied
whilst= at the same time as, concurrently, while

approximately= about, around, roughly
widespread= common, prevalent, general
mainland= landmass, continent, interior
well-dated= able to precisely guess the age
occurrence= existence, incidence
fossil= the shape of a bone, a shell, or a plant or animal that has been preserved in rock for a very long period
extinction= death, disappearance # survival
coincide= concur, happen together, overlap
predator= killer, slayer, hunter

dramatic= drastic, significant
attribute to= to say or think that something is the result or work of something or someone else
relentless= persistent, unyielding, harsh
undoubtedly= certainly, definitely, unquestionably

a large part, it is likely that various other factors also contributed to the decline and **eventual** extinction of the species. These include competition with wild dogs **introduced** by European **settlers**, loss of habitat along with the disappearance of prey species, and a distemper-like disease which may also have affected the thylacine.

There was only one successful attempt to breed a thylacine in **captivity**, at Melbourne Zoo in 1899. This was despite the large numbers that went through some zoos, **particularly** London Zoo and Tasmania's Hobart Zoo. The famous **naturalist** John Gould **foresaw** the thylacine's **demise** when he published his *Mammals of Australia* between 1848 and 1863, writing, 'The numbers of this **singular** animal will **speedily diminish**, **extermination** will have its full **sway**, and it will then, like the wolf of England and Scotland, be recorded as an animal of the past.' However, there seems to have been little public pressure to **preserve** the thylacine, nor was much concern expressed by scientists at the decline of this species in the decades that followed. A **notable exception** was T.T. Flynn, Professor of Biology at the University of Tasmania. In 1914, he was **sufficiently** concerned about the **scarcity** of the thylacine to suggest that some should be **captured** and placed on a small island. But it was not until 1929, with the species on the very **edge** of extinction, that Tasmania's Animals and Birds Protection Board passed a **motion** protecting thylacines only for the month of December, which was thought to be their **prime breeding** season. The last known wild thylacine to be killed was shot by a farmer in the north-east of Tasmania in 1930, leaving just **captive specimens**. Official protection of the species by the Tasmanian government was introduced in July 1936, 59 days before the last known individual died in Hobart Zoo on 7th September, 1936.

There have been **numerous expeditions** and searches for the thylacine over the years, none of which has produced **definitive** evidence that thylacines still exist. The species was **declared** extinct by the Tasmanian government in 1986.

*marsupial: a mammal, such as a kangaroo, whose young are born incompletely developed and are typically carried and suckled in a pouch on the mother's belly

**bounty hunters: people who are paid a reward for killing a wild animal

eventual= ultimate, final, concluding
introduce= to put something into use, operation, or a place for the first time
settler= colonizer, immigrant, incomer

captivity= enclosure, detention, confinement
particularly= especially, specifically, outstandingly
naturalist= biologist, zoologist, environmentalist
foresee= predict, forecast, anticipate
demise= death, loss, decease
singular= unique, outstanding, particular
speedily= quickly, rapidly, immediately
diminish= reduce, weaken, fade
extermination= extinction, termination # preservation
sway= power, control, influence
preserve= maintain, protect, conserve
notable= distinguished, prominent, noteworthy
exception= exclusion, omission, exemption
sufficiently= adequately, satisfactorily, appropriately
scarcity= shortage, lack, insufficiency
capture= take, seize, catch
edge= brink, verge, threshold
motion= a formal suggestion made, discussed, and voted on at a meeting
prime= best, superior
breeding= the process in which animals have sex and produce young animals
captive= caged, imprisoned, in prison
specimen= example, case, sample

numerous= many, plentiful, abundant
expedition= trip, voyage, excursion,

definitive= conclusive, ultimate, absolute
declare= state, announce, pronounce

READING PASSAGE 2



A.

Palm oil is an **edible** oil **derived** from the fruit of the African oil palm tree, and is currently the most **consumed** vegetable oil in the world. It's almost **certainly** in the soap we wash with in the morning, the sandwich we have for lunch, and the biscuits we **snack** on during the day. Why is palm oil so attractive for **manufacturers**? **Primarily** because its **unique properties**- such as remaining **solid** at room temperature - make it an **ideal** ingredient for long-term **preservation**, allowing many **packaged** foods on supermarket shelves to have 'best before' dates of months, even years, into the future.

B.

Many farmers have **seized** the opportunity to maximise the planting of oil palm trees. Between 1990 and 2012, the global land area **devoted** to growing oil palm trees grew from 6 to 17 million hectares, now

edible= something that is edible can be eaten
derive= get, obtain, receive
consume= use, utilize, eat
certainly= surely, absolutely, definitely
snack= to eat small amounts of food between main meals
manufacturer= producer, industrialist, company
primarily= mainly, essentially, for the most part
unique= rare, exclusive, exceptional
property= quality, characteristic
solid= hard, firm
ideal= perfect, fitting, suitable
preservation= maintenance, conservation, continuation
package= pack, wrap, bundle

seize= capture, grab, grasp
devote= dedicate, give, offer
account for= to form part of a total

accounting for around ten percent of total cropland in the entire world. From a **mere** two million tonnes of palm oil being produced **annually globally** 50 years ago, there are now around 60 million tonnes produced every single year, a figure looking likely to double or even triple by the middle of the century.

C.

However, there are **multiple** reasons why **conservationists cite** the rapid **spread** of oil palm **plantations** as a major concern. There are **countless** news stories of **deforestation, habitat destruction** and **dwindling** species populations, all as a direct result of land clearing to establish oil palm tree **monoculture** on an industrial scale, particularly in Malaysia and Indonesia. **Endangered** species - most famously the Sumatran **orangutan**, but also rhinos, elephants, tigers, and numerous other **fauna** - have suffered from the unstoppable spread of oil palm plantations.

D.

'Palm oil is surely one of the greatest threats to global **biodiversity**,' **declares** Dr Farnon Ellwood of the University of the West of England, Bristol. 'Palm oil is replacing **rainforest**, and rainforest is where all the species are. That's a problem.' This has led to some **radical** questions among **environmentalists**, such as whether consumers should try to **boycott** palm oil **entirely**.

Meanwhile Bhavani Shankar, Professor at London's School of Oriental and African Studies, argues, 'It's easy to say that palm oil is the enemy and we should be against it. It makes for a more **dramatic** story, and it's very **intuitive**. But given the **complexity** of the argument, I think a much more **nuanced** story is closer to the truth.'

E.

One response to the **boycott** movement has been the argument for the **vital** role palm oil plays in lifting many millions of people in the developing world out of **poverty**. Is it desirable to have palm oil boycotted, replaced, **eliminated** from the global **supply chain**, given how many low-income people in developing countries depend on it for their **livelihoods**? How best to **strike** a **utilitarian**

mere= used to emphasize how small or unimportant something or someone is

annually= yearly, once a year, every twelve months

globally= internationally, worldwide, universally

multiple= many, numerous, various

conservationist= someone who works to protect animals, plants etc or to protect old buildings

cite= quote, name, mention

spread= expansion, development, increase

plantation= farm, agricultural estate, cultivated area

countless= uncountable, innumerable, immeasurable
deforestation= the cutting or burning down of all the trees in an area

habitat= home, environment, locale

destruction= ruin, damage, devastation

dwindling= declining, deteriorating, falling

monoculture= the practice of growing only one crop or keeping only one type of animal on an area of farm land

endangered= rare, threatened, vulnerable

orangutan= a large ape with long arms and long orange-brown hair

fauna= wildlife, creature, animal

biodiversity= the variety of plants and animals in a particular place

declare= state, announce, affirm

rainforest= a tropical forest with tall trees that are very close together, growing in an area where it rains a lot

radical= fundamental, essential, profound

environmentalist= someone who is concerned about protecting the environment

boycott= refuse, avoid, reject

entirely= completely, totally, absolutely

dramatic= spectacular, extraordinary, remarkable

intuitive= instinctive, spontaneous, impulsive

complexity= difficulty, intricacy, sophistication

nuanced= made slightly different in appearance, meaning, sound, etc.

vital= fundamental, imperative, crucial

poverty= the condition of being extremely poor

eliminate= remove, eradicate, abolish

supply chain= the system of getting a product from the place where it is made to the person who buys it

livelihood= living, income, source of revenue

strike= hit, reach, achieve

utilitarian= useful, practical, down-to-earth

balance between these **competing** factors has become a serious **bone of contention**.

F.

Even the deforestation argument isn't as **straightforward** as it seems. Oil palm plantations produce at least four and **potentially** up to ten times more oil per hectare than soybean, rapeseed, sunflower or other competing oils. That **immensely** high **yield** - which is **predominantly** what makes it so profitable - is potentially also an **ecological** benefit. If ten times more palm oil can be produced from a **patch** of land than any competing oil, then ten times more land would need to be cleared in order to produce the same **volume** of oil from that **competitor**.

As for the question of carbon **emissions**, the issue really depends on what oil palm trees are replacing. Crops vary in the degree to which they **sequester** carbon - in other words, the amount of carbon they capture from the atmosphere and store within the plant. The more carbon a plant sequesters, the more it reduces the effect of climate change. As Shankar explains: ' [Palm oil production] actually sequesters more carbon in some ways than other **alternatives**. [...] Of course, if you're cutting down **virgin forest** it's terrible - that's what's happening in Indonesia and Malaysia; it's been allowed to get **out of hand**. But if it's replacing rice, for example, it might actually sequester more carbon.'

G.

The industry is now **regulated** by a group called the Roundtable on Sustainable Palm Oil (RSPO), consisting of palm growers, retailers, product manufacturers, and other interested **parties**. Over the past decade or so, an **agreement** has **gradually** been reached regarding standards that producers of palm oil have to meet in order for their product to be regarded as officially ' **sustainable**'. The RSPO **insists** upon no virgin forest clearing, **transparency** and regular **assessment** of carbon stocks, among other **criteria**. Only once these requirements are fully satisfied is the oil allowed to be sold as **certified** sustainable palm oil (CSPO). Recent figures show that the RSPO now certifies around 12 million tonnes of palm oil annually, **equivalent** to **roughly** 21 percent of the world's total palm oil production.

competing= opposing, challenging, rival
a bone of contention= something that two or more people argue about strongly over a long period of time

straightforward= upfront, uncomplicated, direct
potentially= possibly, theoretically, hypothetically
immensely= hugely, enormously, massively
yield= production, harvest
predominantly= mainly, principally, primarily
ecological= environmental, biological, natural
patch= area, spot, piece
volume= size, capacity, quantity
competitor= rival, contestant, opponent

emission= release, discharge, emanation
sequester= to separate and store a harmful substance
alternative= replacement, substitute, another possibility
virgin forest= A virgin forest or area of land has not yet been cultivated or used by people
out of hand= uncontrollable, out of control, unmanageable

regulate= control, adjust, standardize
party= participant, organization, contributor
agreement= contract, settlement, deal
gradually= progressively, steadily, regularly
sustainable= maintainable, supportable, viable
insist= require, demand, enforce
transparency= honesty, without secret
assessment= valuation, calculation, judgement
criterion= standard, principle, condition

certified= qualified, licensed, official
equivalent= corresponding, comparable, equal
roughly= approximately, about, around

H.

There is even hope that oil palm plantations might not need to be such **sterile** monocultures, or 'green deserts', as Ellwood describes them. New research at Ellwood's lab **hints** at one plant which might make all the difference. The **bird's nest fern** (*Asplenium nidus*) grows on trees in an **epiphytic fashion** (meaning it's dependent on the tree only for support, not for **nutrients**), and is native to many tropical regions, where as a **keystone** species it performs a vital ecological role. Ellwood believes that reintroducing the bird's nest fern into oil palm plantations could potentially allow these areas to recover their **biodiversity**, providing a home for all **manner** of species, from **fungi** and bacteria, to **invertebrates** such as insects, **amphibians**, **reptiles** and even **mammals**.

sterile= lacking diversity

hint= suggest, refer to, mention

bird's nest fern= a green plant with long stems, leaves like feathers, and no flowers

epiphytic= relating to a plant that grows on another plant but does not feed from it

fashion= method, technique

nutrient= a chemical or food that provides what is needed for plants or animals to live and grow

keystone= foundation, base, cornerstone

biodiversity= the number and types of plants and animals that exist in a particular area

manner= type, kind, sort

fungi= mushroom, molds, toadstool

invertebrate= a living creature that does not have a backbone

amphibian= an animal such as a frog that can live both on land and in water

reptile= a type of animal whose body temperature changes according to the temperature around it

mammal= a type of animal that drinks milk from its mother's body when it is young.

READING PASSAGE 3

Building the Skyline: The Birth and Growth of Manhattan's skyscrapers

Katharine L. Shester reviews a book by Jason Barr about the development of New York City

In *Building the Skyline*, Jason Barr takes the reader through a **detailed** history of New York City. The book combines geology, history, economics, and a lot of data to explain why business **clusters** developed where they did and how the early decisions of workers and firms shaped the **skyline** we see today. *Building the Skyline* is organized into two **distinct** parts. The first is **primarily** historical and addresses New York's settlement and growth from 1609 to 1900; the second deals primarily with the 20th century and is a **compilation** of chapters commenting on different aspects of New York's **urban** development. The **tone** and organization of the book change **somewhat** between the first and second parts, as the **latter** chapters **incorporate** aspects of Barr's related research **papers**.

detailed= thorough, comprehensive, meticulous
cluster= bunch, group, collection
skyline= horizon, distance, prospect
distinct= separate, different, distinctive
primarily= chiefly, mainly, principally
compilation= collection, gathering, assembling
urban= city, metropolitan, rural
tone= style, spirit
somewhat= slightly, fairly, to some extent
latter= second, later, last

incorporate= merge, include, integrate
paper= document, record, manuscript

Barr begins chapter one by taking the reader on a 'helicopter time-machine' ride - giving a **fascinating account** of how the New York **landscape** in 1609 might have looked from the sky. He then moves on to a **subterranean** walking tour of the city, indicating the location of rock and water below the **subsoil**, before taking the reader back to the surface. His love of the city comes through as he describes **various** fun facts about the location of the New York **residence** of early 19th-century vice-president Aaron Burr as well as a number of **legends** about the city.

Chapters two and three take the reader up to the Civil War (1861- 1865), with chapter two focusing on the early development of land and the **implementation** of a **grid** system in 1811. Chapter three focuses on land use before the Civil War. Both chapters are **informative** and well-researched and **set the stage for** the economic analysis that comes later in the book. I would have liked Barr to expand upon his claim that existing **tenements*** prevented **skyscrapers** in certain neighborhoods because 'likely no skyscraper developer was interested in performing the necessary "slum clearance"'. Later in the book, Barr makes the claim that the depth of bedrock** was not a limiting factor for developers, as **foundation** costs were a small **fraction** of the cost of development. At first **glance**, it is not obvious why slum clearance would be limiting, while more expensive foundations would not.

Chapter four focuses on **immigration** and the location of neighborhoods and tenements in the late 19th century. Barr identifies four primary **immigrant enclaves** and analyzes their locations in terms of the **amenities** available in the area. Most of these enclaves were located on the least **valuable** land, between the industries located on the **waterfront** and the **wealthy** neighborhoods **bordering** Central Park.

Part two of the book begins with a discussion of the economics of skyscraper height. In chapter five, Barr **distinguishes** between **engineering** height, economic height, and developer height - where engineering height is the tallest building that can be safely made at a given time, economic height is the height that is most **efficient** from society's point of view, and developer height is the actual height chosen by the developer, who is **attempting to maximize return on investment**.

Chapter five also has an interesting discussion of the technological **advances** that led to the **construction** of skyscrapers. For example, the introduction of iron

fascinating= captivating, charming, intriguing
account= description, explanation, justification
landscape= scenery, setting, background
subterranean= under the ground
subsoil= the layer of soil that is under the surface level
various= numerous, diverse, assorted
residence= a home
legend= fairytale, folklore, folk tale

implementation= installation employment, putting into practice
grid= a system of wires through which electricity is connected to different power stations
informative= providing a lot of useful information
set the stage for= to make it possible for something else to happen
tenement= a large building divided into apartments, usually in a poor area of a city
skyscraper= tower, multistory building, high-rise building
slum= a house or an area of a city that is in very bad condition, where very poor people live
clearance= removal, erasure
foundation= groundwork, base, ground
fraction= portion, segment, part
glance= look, glimpse,

immigration= migration, arrival, entry
immigrant= settler, migrant, refugee
enclave= area, territory, community
amenity= facility, convenience, comfort
valuable= appreciated, precious, valued
waterfront= seaside, waterside, beachfront
wealthy= rich, affluent, prosperous
border= be next to, run alongside, be adjacent to

distinguish= analyze, differentiate, discriminate
engineering= the work involved in designing and building roads, bridges, machines etc

efficient= effective, proficient, economical
attempt= try, make an effort, endeavor
maximize= boost, increase, expand
return on investment= the profit from an activity compared with the amount invested in it
advance= development, improvement, breakthrough
construction= creation, manufacture, composition
skeletal= of or like a frame of bones
load-bearing= supporting the weight of the building above it

and steel **skeletal** frames made thick, **load-bearing** walls unnecessary, expanding the usable **square footage** of buildings and increasing the use of windows and **availability** of natural light. Chapter six then presents data on building height **throughout** the 20th century and uses **regression analysis** to 'predict' building construction. While less **technical** than the research paper on which the chapter is based, it is **probably** more technical than would be preferred by a general **audience**.

Chapter seven **tackles** the 'bedrock **myth**', the **assumption** that the **absence** of bedrock close to the surface between Downtown and Midtown New York is the reason for skyscrapers not being built between the two urban centers. Rather, Barr argues that while deeper **bedrock** does increase foundation costs, these costs were neither **prohibitively** high nor were they large compared to the overall cost of building a skyscraper. What I enjoyed the most about this chapter was Barr's discussion of how foundations are actually built. He describes the use of **caissons**, which enable workers to **dig** down for considerable distances, often below the **water table**, until they reach bedrock. Barr's thorough technological history discusses not only how caissons work, but also the dangers involved. While this chapter **references** **empirical** research papers, it is a **relatively** easy read.

Chapters eight and nine focus on the birth of Midtown and the building **boom** of the 1920s. Chapter eight contains **lengthy** discussions of urban economic theory that may serve as a distraction to readers primarily interested in New York. However, they would be well-suited for **undergraduates** learning about the economics of cities. In the next chapter, Barr considers two of the primary explanations for the building boom of the 1920s -the first being **exuberance**, and the second being financing. He uses data to assess the **viability** of these two explanations and finds that supply and demand factors explain much of the development of the 1920s; though it enabled the boom, cheap **credit** was not, he argues, the primary cause.

In the final chapter (chapter 10), Barr discusses another of his **empirical** papers that **estimates** Manhattan land values from the mid-19th century to the present day. The data work that went into these estimations is particularly **impressive**. Toward the end of the chapter, Barr assesses 'whether skyscrapers are a cause or an effect of high land values. He finds

square footage= an area measured in feet
availability= readiness, obtainability, abundance
throughout= during, the whole time
regression analysis= a method in statistics that compares the way two or more related sets of numbers have changed over a particular period
technical= practical, mechanical, methodological
probably= perhaps, maybe, possibly
audience= viewers, watchers, spectators

tackle= solve, stop, confront
myth= falsehood, untruth, fiction
assumption= supposition, hypothesis, statement
absence= lack, nonexistence, deficiency
bedrock= foundation, base
prohibitively= excessively, exorbitantly, expensively
caisson= a structure that goes under water or underground and keeps water out, used in building
dig= to form a hole by moving soil
water table= the level below the surface of the ground at which you start to find water
reference= link to, quote
empirical= experiential, observed, practical
relatively= comparatively, moderately, fairly

boom= explosion, escalation, surge
lengthy= long, extensive, long-lasting
undergraduate= a student at college or university, who is working for their first-degree
exuberance= lavishness
viability= feasibility, practicality, capability
credit= a method of paying for goods or services at a later time

empirical= using experience
estimate= assess, guess, value
impressive= striking, remarkable, notable

that changes in land values **predict** future building height, but the **reverse** is not true. The book ends with an **epilogue**, in which Barr discusses the impact of climate change on the city and makes policy **suggestions** for New York going **forward**.

predict= forecast, foresee, expect
reverse= opposite, contrary, opposite
epilogue= a speech or piece of text that is added to the end of a play or book
suggestion= hint, proposal, implication
forward= ahead, further, progress

Test 4

READING PASSAGE 1

Bats to the rescue

How Madagascar's bats are helping to save the rainforest

There are few places in the world where relations between agriculture and **conservation** are more **strained**. Madagascar's forests are being **converted** to agricultural land at a rate of one percent every year. Much of this **destruction** is **fuelled** by the **cultivation** of the country's main **staple** crop: rice. And a **key** reason for this destruction is that insect **pests** are destroying **vast** quantities of what is grown by local **subsistence** farmers, leading them to clear forest to create new **paddy** fields. The result is **devastating** habitat and **biodiversity** loss on the island, but not all species are suffering. In fact, some of the island's **insectivorous** bats are currently **thriving** and this has important **implications** for farmers and **conservationists** alike.

rainforest= a tropical forest with tall trees that are very close together, growing in an area where it rains a lot

conservation= protection, saving, preservation
strained= stressed, tense, anxious
convert= change, switch, move
destruction= ruin, damage, demolition
fuel= stimulate, energize, promote
cultivation= farming, agriculture, gardening
staple= basic, core, prime
key= crucial, significant, important
pest= insect, bug, vermin
vast= huge, massive, enormous
subsistence= existence, maintenance, sustenance
paddy= a field in which rice is grown in water
devastating= overwhelming, shocking, upsetting
biodiversity= the variety of plants and animals in a particular place
insectivore= a creature that eats insects for food
thriving= blooming, increasing
implication= suggestion, insinuation, consequence
conservationist= ecologist, environmentalist, preservationist

Enter University of Cambridge zoologist Ricardo Rocha. He's **passionate** about conservation, and bats. More specifically, he's interested in how bats are responding to human activity and **deforestation** in particular. Rocha's new study shows that several species of bats are giving Madagascar's rice farmers a vital pest control service by **feasting** on **plagues** of insects. And this, he believes, can **ease** the financial pressure on farmers to turn forest into fields.

Bats **comprise** roughly one-fifth of all **mammal** species in Madagascar and thirty-six recorded bat species are **native** to the island, making it one of the most important regions for conservation of this animal group anywhere in the world.

Co-leading an international team of scientists, Rocha found that several species of **indigenous** bats are **taking advantage of** habitat **modification** to hunt insects **swarming** above the country's rice fields. They include the Malagasy mouse-eared bat, Major's long-fingered bat, the Malagasy white-bellied free-tailed bat, and Peters' wrinkle-lipped bat.

'These winner species are providing a **valuable** free service to Madagascar as biological pest **suppressors**,' says Rocha. 'We found that six species of bat are **preying on** rice pests, including the **paddy swarming caterpillar** and grass **webworm**. The damage which these insects cause puts the island's farmers under huge financial pressure and that encourages deforestation.'

The study, now published in the **journal** Agriculture, Ecosystems and Environment, **set out to investigate** the feeding activity of **insectivorous** bats in the farmland bordering the Ranomafana National Park in the southeast of the country.

Rocha and his team used **state-of-the-art ultrasonic** recorders to record over a thousand bat 'feeding buzzes' (**echolocation** used by bats to **target** their prey) at 54 sites, in order to identify the favourite feeding spots of the bats. They next used DNA barcoding techniques to analyse droppings collected from bats at the different sites.

The recordings **revealed** that bat activity over rice fields was much higher than it was in continuous forest - seven times higher over rice fields which were on flat ground, and sixteen times higher over fields on the sides of hills - leaving no doubt that the

passionate= obsessive, enthusiastic
deforestation= the cutting or burning down of all the trees in an area
feast= eat, devour, indulge
a plague of= a large number of things that are unpleasant or likely to cause damage
ease= relieve, reduce, lessen

comprise= to be the parts of something; to make up something
mammal= any animal of which the female feeds her young on milk from her own body
native= local, indigenous, domestic

indigenous= local, innate, natural
take advantage of= make the most of, exploit, make use of
modification= alteration, change, adjustment
swarm= crowd, mass, flock

valuable= useful, precious, beneficial
suppressor= a thing or person that prevents something bad from happening
prey on= hunt, catch
paddy= a field in which rice is grown in water
swarm= crowd, mass, flock
caterpillar= a small creature like a worm with many legs that eats leaves and that develops into a butterfly or other flying insect
webworm= a caterpillar which spins a web in which to rest or feed

journal= a serious magazine or newspaper that is published regularly about a particular subject
set out= to start an activity with a particular aim
investigate= examine, explore, study
insectivorous= eating only insects

state-of-the-art= advanced, high-tech, up-to-the-minute
ultrasonic= ultrasonic sound waves are too high for humans to hear
echolocation= a process in which animals, find their way in the dark by producing sound waves that echo when they are reflected off an object
target= pursue, seek out, be after

reveal= disclose, unveil, uncover
preferentially= especially, specifically, favorably
forage= search for food
man-made= artificial, synthetic # natural
pest= bug, insect

animals are **preferentially foraging** in these **man-made** ecosystems. The researchers suggest that the bats favour these fields because lack of water and nutrient **run-off** make these crops more **susceptible** to insect **pest infestations**. DNA analysis showed that all six species of bat had fed on economically important insect pests. While the findings indicated that rice farming benefits most from the bats, the scientists also found indications that the bats were consuming pests of other crops, including the black **twig borer** (which **infests** coffee plants), the **sugarcane cicada**, the macadamia nut-borer, and the sober tabby (a pest of citrus fruits).

'The **effectiveness** of bats as pest controllers has already been proven in the USA and Catalonia,' said co-author James Kemp, from the University of Lisbon. 'But our study is the first to show this happening in Madagascar, where the **stakes** for both farmers and conservationists are so high.'

Local people may have a further reason to be grateful to their bats. While the animal is often associated with spreading disease, Rocha and his team found evidence that Malagasy bats feed not just on crop pests but also on **mosquitoes - carriers** of malaria, Rift Valley **fever** virus and elephantiasis - as well as blackflies, which spread **river blindness**.

Rocha **points out** that the relationship is complicated. When food is **scarce**, bats become a crucial source of protein for local people. Even the children will hunt them. And as well as **roosting** in trees, the bats sometimes roost in buildings, but are not welcomed there because they make them unclean. At the same time, however, they are **associated with sacred** caves and the **ancestors**, so they can be viewed as beings between worlds, which makes them very **significant** in the culture of the people. And one **potential** problem is that while these bats are benefiting from farming, at the same time deforestation is reducing the places where they can roost, which could have long-term effects on their numbers. Rocha says, 'With the right help, we hope that farmers can promote this **mutually** beneficial relationship by installing bat houses.'

Rocha and his **colleagues** believe that maximising bat populations can help to boost crop **yields** and promote **sustainable livelihoods**. The team is now calling for further research to **quantify** this contribution. 'I'm very optimistic,' says Rocha. 'If we **give** nature **a hand**, we can speed up the process of **regeneration**.'

run-off= rain or other liquid that flows off the land into rivers
susceptible= vulnerable, prone to, at risk
infestation= a large number of animals and insects that carry disease
twig borer= any of several beetles, beetle larvae that bore into the twigs
infest= to cause a problem by being present in large numbers
sugarcane= a tall tropical plant from whose stems sugar is obtained
cicada= an insect that lives in hot countries, has large transparent wings, and makes a high singing noise

effectiveness= efficiency, success, achievement
stake= investment, claim, share

mosquito= a small flying insect that sucks the blood of people and animals
carrier= a person or thing that carries something
fever= an illness or a medical condition in which you have a very high temperature
river blindness= disease that affects the skin and eyes

point out= show, indicate, mention
scarce= if something is scarce, there is not very much of it available
roost= settle, rest, sleep
associate with= relate to, connect with, link to
sacred= considered to be holy and deserving respect, especially because of a connection with a god
ancestor= forebear, antecedent, predecessor
significant= important, noteworthy, remarkable
potential= possible, probable
mutually= jointly, equally, commonly

colleague= coworker, associate, collaborator
yield= the amount of profits, crops etc that something produces
sustainable= maintainable, supportable, bearable
livelihood= living, source of revenue, income
quantify= calculate, compute, measure
give sb a hand= help, support, aid
regeneration= renewal, rebirth, redevelopment

READING PASSAGE 2

Does education fuel economic growth?

Over the last decade, a huge **database** about the lives of southwest German villagers between 1600 and 1900 has been **compiled** by a team led by Professor Sheilagh Ogilvie at Cambridge University's Faculty of Economics. It includes **court** records, **guild ledgers**, **parish registers**, village **censuses**, tax lists, and - the most recent addition - 9,000 **handwritten inventories** listing over a million personal **possessions** belonging to **ordinary** women and men across three centuries. Ogilvie, who discovered the inventories in the **archives** of two German communities 30 years ago, believes they may hold the answer to a **conundrum** that has long **puzzled** economists: the lack of evidence for a **causal link** between education and a country's economic growth.

B. As Ogilvie explains, 'Education helps us to work more **productively**, **invent** better technology, and earn more ... surely it must be **critical** for economic growth? But, if you look back through history, there's

database= databank, folder, file
compile= collect, accumulate, compose
court= law court, court of law
guild= association, union
ledger= journal, book, record
parish= church
register= an official list of names of people, companies etc, or a book that has this list
census= an official process of counting and finding out about the people
handwritten= written by hand, not printed
inventory= list, record, account
possession= property, belongings
ordinary= normal, common, usual
archive= a place where a large number of historical records are stored
conundrum= mystery, puzzle, challenge
puzzle= confuse, bewilder, baffle
causal link= a link between two things in which one causes the other

productively= effectively, successfully
invent= create, discover, formulate
critical= significant, important, vital

no evidence that having a high **literacy** rate made a country **industrialize** earlier.' Between 1600 and 1900, England had only **mediocre** literacy rates by European standards, yet its economy grew fast and it was the first country to **industrialize**. During this period, Germany and Scandinavia had excellent literacy rates, but their economies grew slowly and they industrialized late. 'Modern cross-country analyses have also struggled to find evidence that education causes economic growth, even though there is plenty of evidence that growth increases education,' she adds.

C. In the handwritten inventories that Ogilvie is analysing are the **belongings** of women and men at marriage, remarriage and death. From **badger** skins to Bibles, **sewing** machines to **scarlet bodices** - the villagers' entire **worldly** goods are included. Inventories of agricultural equipment and craft tools reveal economic activities; ownership of books and education related objects like pens and **slates** suggests how people learned. In addition, the tax lists included in the database record the value of farms, workshops, **assets** and debts; **signatures** and people's estimates of their age indicate literacy and numeracy levels; and court records reveal obstacles (such as the activities of the **guilds***) that **stifled** industry.

Previous studies usually had just one way of linking education with economic growth - the presence of schools and **printing presses**, perhaps, or school enrolment, or the ability to sign names. According to Ogilvie, the database provides multiple **indicators** for the same individuals, making it possible to analyse links between literacy, numeracy, wealth, and **industriousness**, for individual women and men over the long term.

D. Ogilvie and her team have been building a **vast** database of material possessions on top of their full **demographic reconstruction** of the people who lived in these two German communities. 'We can follow the same people - and their **descendants** - across 300 years of educational and economic change,' she says. Individual lives have **unfolded** before their eyes. Stories like that of the 24-year-olds Ana Regina and Magdalena Riethmiillerin, who were **chastised** in 1707 for reading books in church instead of listening to the **sermon**. 'This tells us they

literacy= reading ability, knowledge, learning
industrialise= if a country or area industrializes, it develops a lot of industry for the first time
mediocre= middling, average, unexceptional
industrialise= if a country or area industrializes, it develops a lot of industry for the first time

belongings= possession, property
sewing= embroidery, stitching
badger= an animal that has black and white fur, lives in holes in the ground
scarlet= bright red
bodice= the upper part of a woman's dress
worldly= relating to physical things and ordinary life
asset= possession, property, holding
signature= name, mark, autograph
guild= an organization of people who do the same job or have the same interests
slate= in the past, a small, thin, rectangular piece of rock, usually in a wooden frame, used for writing on
stifle= stop, prevent, hamper

printing press= an old printing machine
indicator= marker, guide, pointer
industriousness= hard work, diligence, productiveness

vast= great, massive, enormous
demographic= relating to the population and groups of people in it
reconstruction= model, recreation
descendant= child, inheritor, offspring
sermon= talk, lecture, lesson
unfold= If a situation or story unfolds, it becomes clear to other people
chastise= penalize, scold, punish

were continuing to develop their reading skills at least a decade after leaving school,' explains Ogilvie. The database also reveals the case of Juliana Schweickherdt, a 50-year-old **spinster** living in the small Black Forest community of Wildberg, who was **reprimanded** in 1752 by the local weavers' guild for 'weaving cloth and combing wool, **counter** to the guild **ordinance**'. When Juliana continued taking jobs reserved for male guild members, she was **summoned** before the guild court and told to pay a fine **equivalent** to one-third of a **servant's** annual wage. It was a small act of **defiance** by today's standards, but it **reflects** a time when laws in Germany and elsewhere **regulated** people's access to labour markets. The **dominance** of guilds not only prevented people from using their skills, but also **held back** even the simplest industrial innovation.

E. The data-gathering **phase** of the project has been completed and now, according to Ogilvie, it is time 'to ask the big questions'. One way to look at whether education causes economic growth is to 'hold wealth **constant**'. This involves following the lives of different people with the same level of wealth over a period of time. If wealth is constant, it is possible to discover whether education was, for example, linked to the **cultivation** of new crops, or to the **adoption** of industrial innovations like sewing machines. The team will also ask what aspect of education helped people engage more with productive and innovative activities. Was it, for instance, literacy, numeracy, book ownership, years of schooling? Was there a **threshold** level - a **tipping point** - that needed to be reached to affect economic performance?

F. Ogilvie hopes to start finding answers to these questions over the next few years. One thing is already clear, she says: the relationship between education and economic growth is far from **straightforward**. 'German-speaking central Europe is an excellent laboratory for testing theories of economic growth,' she explains. Between 1600 and 1900, literacy rates and book ownership were high and yet the region remained poor. It was also the case that local guilds and **merchant associations** were extremely powerful and **legislated** against anything that **undermined** their **monopolies**. In villages throughout the region, guilds

spinster= an unmarried woman, usually one who is no longer young and seems unlikely to marry
reprimand= tell off, scold, rebuke
counter= dispute, argue against, oppose
ordinance= order, rule, regulation
summon= to order someone to come to or be present at a particular place
equivalent= the same as, equal, corresponding
servant= a person who is employed in another person's house, doing housework, especially in the past
defiance= disobedience, insolence, rebelliousness
reflect= reveal, expose, display
regulate= control, adjust, order
dominance= supremacy, power, preeminence
held back= to stop someone or something developing or doing as well as they should

phase= stage, time, period
constant= steady, stable, invariable
cultivation= farming, agricultural, gardening
adoption= acceptance, implementation, application
threshold= line, limit, base
tipping point= the time at which a change or an effect cannot be stopped

straightforward= simple, clear-cut, uncomplicated
merchant= wholesaler, dealer, trader
association= union, organization, group
legislate= If a government legislates, it makes a new law
undermine= weaken, destabilize, threaten
monopoly= domination, supremacy, authority

blocked labour **migration** and **resisted** changes that might reduce their influence.

Early findings suggest that the potential benefits of education for the economy can be held back by other **barriers**, and this has implications for today,' says Ogilvie.' Huge amounts are spent improving education in developing countries, but this spending can fail to **deliver** economic growth if **restrictions** block people - especially women and the poor - from using their education in economically productive ways. If economic institutions are **poorly** set up, for instance, education can't lead to growth.'

block= prevent, stop, deter
migration= relocation, passage, movement
resist= fight, battle, struggle

barrier= blockade, obstacle, difficulty
deliver= to achieve or produce something that has been promised
restriction= limit, border, margin
poorly= badly, inadequately

READING PASSAGE 3



Timur Gareyev - blindfold chess champion

A. **N**ext month, a chess player named Timur Gareyev will **take on** nearly 50 **opponents** at once. But that is not the hard part. While his **challengers** will play the games as normal, Gareyev himself will be **blindfolded**. Even by world record standards, it **sets a high bar** for human performance. The 28-year-old already **stands out** in the **rarefied** world of blindfold chess. He has a **fondness** for bright clothes and unusual hairstyles, and he gets his **kicks** from the adventure sport of **BASE jumping**. He has already proved himself a strong chess player, too. In a 10-hour chess marathon in 2013, Gareyev played 33 games in his head **simultaneously**. He won 29 and lost none. The skill has become his brand: he calls himself the Blindfold King.

B. But Gareyev's **prowess** has drawn interest from beyond the chess-playing community. In the hope of

blindfold= a piece of cloth that covers someone's eyes to prevent them from seeing anything
take on= to compete against
opponent= competitor, enemy, rival
challenger= contestant, competitor, antagonist
blindfold= to cover someone's eyes with a piece of cloth
set a high bar for= to set a high standard for something
stand out= be noticeable, be prominent, catch the eye
rarefied= different, exclusive
fondness= liking, affection, love
kick= pleasure, excitement, thrill
BASE jumping= the sport of jumping from a high building, bridge, etc. with a parachute
simultaneously= at once, concurrently, at the same time

prowess= skill, ability, talent

understanding how he and others like him can perform such mental **feats**, researchers at the University of California in Los Angeles (UCLA) called him in for tests. They now have their first results. 'The ability to play a game of chess with your eyes closed is not a far **reach** for most **accomplished** players,' said Jesse Rissman, who **runs** a memory lab at UCLA. 'But the thing that's so **remarkable** about Timur and a few other individuals is the number of games they can keep active at once. To me it is simply **astonishing**.'

C. Gareyev learned to play chess in his **native** Uzbekistan when he was six years old. Tutored by his grandfather, he entered his first **tournament** aged eight and soon became **obsessed with** competitions. At 16, he was crowned Asia's youngest ever chess **grandmaster**. He moved to the US soon after, and as a student helped his university win its first national chess **championship**. In 2013, Gareyev was **ranked** the third best chess player in the US.

D. To the **uninitiated**, blindfold chess seems to **call for superhuman** skill. But displays of the feat **go back** centuries. The first recorded game in Europe was played in 13th-century Florence. In 1947, the Argentinian grandmaster Miguel Najdorf played 45 simultaneous games in his mind, winning 39 in the 24-hour session.

E. **Accomplished** players can develop the skill of playing blind even without realising it. The nature of the game is to run through possible **moves** in the mind to see how they play out. From this, regular players develop a memory for the patterns the pieces make, the **defences** and attacks. 'You recreate it in your mind,' said Gareyev. 'A lot of players are **capable** of doing what I'm doing.' The real **mental** challenge comes from playing **multiple** games at once in the head. Not only must the positions of each piece on every board be **memorised**, they must be recalled **faithfully** when needed, updated with each player's moves, and then **reliably** stored again, so the brain can move on to the next board. First moves can be tough to remember because they are fairly uninteresting. But the ends of games are **taxing** too, as exhaustion **sets in**. When Gareyev is tired, his recall can get **patchy**. He sometimes makes moves based on only a **fragmented** memory of the pieces' positions.

feat= something difficult needing a lot of skill, strength, courage, etc. to achieve it
reach= the limit within which someone can achieve something
accomplished= talented, skillful, proficient,
run= manage, operate, function

remarkable= extraordinary, amazing, outstanding
astonishing= surprising, astounding, beyond belief

native= home, country
tournament= game, contest, competition
obsess with= fascinate, possess, preoccupy
grand master= a chess player of a very high standard
championship= competition, tournament, contest
rank= rate, categorize

uninitiated= amateur, nonprofessional, inexperienced
call for= need, require, necessitate
superhuman= prodigious, extraordinary, phenomenal
go back= begin, start, originate

accomplished= talented, skillful, gifted
move= a change of the position of one of the pieces used to play the game
defence= the act of protecting something or someone from attack
capable= proficient, skilled, able
mental= psychological, intellectual, emotional
multiple= many, numerous, several
memorise= to learn words, music etc so that you know them perfectly
faithfully= accurately, precisely, believably
reliably= dependably, consistently, consistently
taxing= exhausting, draining, tiring

set in= appear, emerge, crop up
patchy= If information is patchy, only small parts of it are known
fragmented= disorganized, frazzled

F. The scientists first had Gareyev perform some standard memory tests. These **assessed** his ability to hold numbers, pictures and words in mind. One classic test measures how many numbers a person can repeat, both forwards and backwards, soon after hearing them. Most people **manage** about seven. 'He was not **exceptional** on any of these standard tests,' said Rissman. 'We didn't find anything other than playing chess that he seems to be **supremely gifted** at.' But next came the brain scans. With Gareyev lying down in the machine, Rissman looked at how well connected the various regions of the chess player's brain were. Though the results are **tentative** and as yet unpublished, the scans found much greater than average communication between parts of Gareyev's brain that make up what is called the **frontoparietal** control network. Of 63 people scanned alongside the chess player, only one or two scored more highly on the measure. 'You use this network in almost any **complex** task. It helps you to **allocate** attention, keep rules in mind, and **work out** whether you should be responding or not,' said Rissman.

G. It was not the only **hint** of something special in Gareyev's brain. The scans also suggest that Gareyev's **visual** network is more highly connected to other brain parts than usual. **Initial** results suggest that the areas of his brain that process visual images - such as chess boards - may have stronger links to other brain **regions**, and so be more powerful than normal. While the analyses are not finalised yet, they may hold the first **clues** to Gareyev's **extraordinary** ability.

H. For the world record attempt, Gareyev hopes to play 47 blindfold games at once in about 16 hours. He will need to win 80% to claim the **title**. 'I don't worry too much about the winning percentage; that's never been an issue for me,' he said. 'The most important part of blindfold chess for me is that I have found the one thing that I can fully **dedicate** myself to. I miss having an obsession.'

assess= evaluate, measure, judge
manage= achieve, accomplish, succeed
exceptional= excellent, outstanding, brilliant
supremely= extremely, completely, enormously
gifted= talented, skilled, exceptional
tentative= hesitant, cautious, uncertain
frontoparietal= involving both frontal and parietal bones of the skull.
complex= compound, multifaceted
allocate= distribute, assign, appoint
work out= to find the answer to something by thinking about it

hint= clue, suggestion, indication
visual= graphic, pictorial, filmic
Initial= early, primary, premature
region= area, zone, section
clue= sign, hint, evidence
extraordinary= odd, exceptional, remarkable

title= a word that is used before someone's name, stating their social rank, qualifications, etc.
dedicate= contribute, commit, devote

PHỤ LỤC

IELTS READING ANSWER SHEET

Phù hợp việc tự luyện IELTS Reading tại nhà

Để làm tốt bài thi IELTS Reading, một điều quan trọng là có chiến lược làm bài nhanh và hiệu quả. Trong đó, kỹ năng sử dụng answer sheet đóng vai trò rất quan trọng. Một số bạn thậm chí không sử dụng answer sheet trong lúc luyện tập. Điều này là không nên vì rất nhiều trường hợp transfer câu trả lời từ sách sang answer sheet sẽ bị nhầm. Ngoài ra, khác với listening có 10 phút để transfer câu trả lời từ booklet sang answer sheet, trong bài thi reading, các bạn nên điền câu trả lời trực tiếp vào answer sheet lúc làm bài để tiết kiệm tối đa thời gian.

Dưới đây là link answer sheet dùng cho bài thi Reading sử dụng trong các kỳ thi IELTS chính thức



<https://ielts-moscow.ru/files/Reading%20Answer%20Sheet.pdf>

Tuy nhiên, để phục vụ việc ghi chép các lỗi thường gặp trong quá trình làm bài và tạo điều kiện cho việc “rút kinh nghiệm” trong các lần làm bài kế tiếp, các bạn nên sử dụng answer sheet sau

Link download



https://drive.google.com/open?id=1C_bY208s2_zK8FKzJzqCvPpSoCx4TLd8

Ưu điểm của answer sheet này

- Các phần thông tin chỉ dùng cho kỳ thi thật đã được cắt bỏ, thay vào đó là cột thông tin problem và solution để các bạn có thể ghi chú các thông tin cần thiết sau mỗi lần làm bài
- Bảng điểm tham khảo để các bạn tiện đối chiếu sau khi làm bài xong

HƯỚNG DẪN SỬ DỤNG ANSWER SHEET MỚI

Dinhthangietts

This test is from Test 4 Cam9 Date 31st Jan 2018

NOTES

Ghi các vấn đề bạn gặp phải ở cột này

Tự đưa ra các cách giải quyết cho các vấn đề đó ở cột này

#	Problem	Solution
1	Không hiểu câu chứa thông tin quan trọng vì quá dài	Phân tích cấu trúc ngữ pháp câu, lược bỏ phần không quan trọng
2	TRUE FALSE NOT GIVEN bị sai nhiều (40%)	Cần đọc kỹ hơn thông tin và chú ý các từ bẫy như ONLY, ALL, v.v...

Thường xuyên xem lại phần NOTES này, đặc biệt là trước khi bạn làm 1 test bất kỳ vì nó là kinh nghiệm bạn đúc rút được

Thường xuyên làm tại phân họ 125 này, đặc biệt là trước khi bạn làm 1 test bất kỳ		Machine use only	
1	☐ 1 ☐	21	☒ 21 ☐
2	☒ 2 ☐	22	☒ 22 ☐
3	☒ 3 ☐	23	☒ 23 ☐

Sau đó ghim các tờ answer sheet của bạn lại thành 1 quyển và **đọc đi đọc lại** thường xuyên, và đặc biệt là đọc thật kỹ trước khi làm một test mới.



Rất cảm ơn các bạn đã sử dụng cuốn sách. A&M rất mong nhận được thêm những ý kiến đóng góp cũng như những chia sẻ về việc bạn đã dùng sách hiệu quả trong việc làm bài IELTS Reading.

VÀ SẼ LÀ MỘT ĐỘNG LỰC TO LỚN CHO TEAM SOẠN SÁCH KHI BẠN SHARE NHỮNG ĐÁNH GIÁ VỀ CUỐN SÁCH TRÊN CÁC GROUP CŨNG NHƯ FACEBOOK CÁ NHÂN BẠN NHÉ

★★★★★
REVIEW US!

Review tích cực



Uyên Phương Đoàn

10 Tháng 6, 2021 · 🌐

...

Em gái mình là học sinh lớp 11 vừa rồi thi được 8.0 overall. Nhờ tài liệu Boost your vocabulary của Đình Thắng mà em mình đã đạt 9.0 reading. Mình cũng muốn chia sẻ với mọi người video em gái mình tóm tắt lại quá trình tự học và link tài liệu mà em gái mình đã sử dụng để đạt điểm 8.0 Overall (phần mô tả youtube) nhằm lan tỏa năng lực ielts điểm cao. Chúc mọi người đạt được kết quả như ý



i

YOUTUBE.COM

|GÓC CHIA SẺ| Mình đã tự học IELTS 8.0 như thế nào?

Video trên chia sẻ một số kinh nghiệm học tập của mình trong quá trình luyện thi IELTS 8.0. Li...

**Cheng Pi**

2 Tháng 7, 2021 · 🌐

...

REVIEW SÁCH BOOST YOUR VOCABULARY

Boost chính là công cụ giúp tớ làm đề practice tests được 9.0

Tớ bắt đầu sử dụng Boost từ giữa tháng 5 và thời điểm ban đầu mới bắt đầu dig into IELTS, bản thân tớ học rất chậm và cảm thấy reading vô cùng khó. Vấn đề của tớ luôn là đọc hiểu được 70-95% bài nhưng khi làm test thì điểm luôn không được cao (5.0-7.0), vì thế tớ biết chắc chắn là mình đã học sai cách. Thậm chí, tớ còn sợ read hơn cả speak và đôi lúc là wri nữa.

Phát hiện lớn nhất khiến tớ có thể ace reading và writing một cách dễ dàng hơn đó chính là: SYNONYMS. Tớ từng nghe một người thầy ở hội đồng anh nói rằng: Reading thực chất là một trò chơi về synonyms, và bài toán của IELTS chính là paraphrase.

Thực vậy, tớ bắt đầu tạo lập cách học từ vựng khác cho bản thân, đầu tiên đọc văn bản, nhìn synonyms trong boost, nhìn nghĩa tiếng việt nếu cần hiểu thêm về sắc thái từ, và quay lại nhìn synonym một lần nữa (một ưu điểm tớ cực kỳ thích trong boost đấy chính là tớ đã học được rất kỹ về sắc thái từ, và nhận ra lý do vì sao chỉ đọc hiểu cả bài lại không thể được điểm cao).

Trong vòng một tháng tớ chỉ học duy nhất boost 14 với tần suất chỉ 1-3 lần/ tuần, nhưng tớ học rất kỹ, và cố nhớ từ trong boost cho bằng được (đôi lúc tớ cũng tìm thêm từ ở ngoài). Vì vậy mỗi khi tớ nhìn thấy một từ, lập tức trong đầu tớ hiện ra một cách diễn đạt or một từ đồng nghĩa khác. Một lần học một từ trong bài, tớ học được thêm/ ôn lại 4-5 từ khác. Điều đấy khiến tớ chỉ học có 30 từ một lần học, nhưng boost khiến tớ thực chất có thể học được đến hơn 100 từ một lần học.

Và chỉ trong một tháng chỉ học boost và làm cam 14, tớ đã làm các practice tests khác và điểm luôn nằm trong khoảng 8.0-9.0, hiện tại tớ đã tiếp tục làm thêm các cuốn còn lại để cải thiện bản thân hơn. Không dưới 3 lần tớ đạt được 9.0 reading trong test. Châm ngôn của một đồng Amser mà tớ vô cùng thích là: Study less, study smart, học nhiều học chăm mà học sai cách thì cũng chết, mà đồng thời học sai cách sẽ khiến cho bản thân mình nản. Và may mắn thay, Boost chính là công cụ khiến tớ study less, study smart; chỉ còn 1 tháng nữa là tớ thi IELTS và tớ thật sự rất muốn cảm ơn đội ngũ làm sách Boost và thầy Đình Thắng đã giúp tớ tự tin hơn rất nhiều trong việc học reading, một kỹ năng tớ từng coi là nỗi ám ảnh.



Hạ Vy

22 tháng 2 lúc 22:37 · 🌐

...

HOW I GOT 7.5 OVERALL? (9.0 READING, 7.0 SPEAKING & WRITING)

Chào mọi người, dạo gần đây có khá nhiều bạn hỏi mình về cách ôn luyện IELTS nên hôm nay mình ngoi lên share lại cho mọi người cách mình vừa ôn IELTS vừa ôn thi THPT mà vẫn đạt được mục tiêu.

READING: mình học theo bộ sách " Boost your vocabulary " của thầy Đinh Thắng để tăng vốn từ vựng. Mình thường dành ra 2 tiếng buổi sáng để đọc hiểu các bài đọc trong sách Cam, mng đừng coi nó theo kiểu mình đang học Ielts mà nên nghĩ rằng mình đang trau dồi kiến thức, đang đọc báo hoặc drama vì mình thấy những bài reading trong Cam đều hữu ích. Mình hay đọc news trên The guardian nữa. Ngoài ra mình có sở thích đọc sách ngoại văn, không những giúp mình có thể suy nghĩ bằng T.A, hiểu nhanh mà mình còn học được cách hành văn của họ nữa. Hữu ích cho cả spe+wr+read ạ.



Cảm ơn mọi người đã đọc, chúc mọi người học tốt và có thật nhiều sức khỏe ạ. Nếu có câu hỏi nào về tài liệu, phương pháp hay chỗ mình học thì mng cứ nhắn tin cho mình nhé mình sẽ share nhiệt tình ạ 🍷

IELTS™
Test Report Form
ACADEMIC

Centre Number: VN002 Date: 20/NOV/2021 Candidate Number: 012725

Candidate Details

Family Name: NGUYEN
First Name: THI HA VY
Candidate ID: [REDACTED]

Date of Birth: 21/06/2004 Sex (M/F): F Scheme Code: Private Candidate

Country or Region of Origin: [REDACTED]
Country of Nationality: VIETNAM
First Language: VIETNAMESE

Test Results

Listening	Reading	Writing	Speaking	Overall Band Score	CEFR Level
6.5	9.0	7.0	7.0	7.5	C1

Administrator Comments

Centre stamp: VIETNAM BRITISH COUNCIL
Validation stamp: IELTS

Administrator's Signature: [Signature]
Date: 01/12/2021
Test Report Form Number: 21VNS12725NGUT002A

BRITISH COUNCIL idp Cambridge Assessment English

The validity of this IELTS Test Report Form can be verified online by recognising organisations at <http://ieltsa.uses.org.uk>



IELTS Family - Các nhóm tự học IELTS

Nhi Võ Châu Yên · 10 Tháng 11, 2021 · 🌐

...

[REVIEW SÁCH BOOST YOUR VOCAB - CUỐN SÁCH GIÚP MÌNH ĐẠT 8.0 READING]

**Background: Mình bắt đầu học Reading và sử dụng sách Boost vào cuối tháng 6, lúc đó trình độ mình cỡ 5.5 - 6.0, đến 23.10 mình thi thì R được 8.0*

Mình biết để Reading được band cao thì mình thật sự phải hiểu thật sâu bài đọc, chính vì vậy mình đã quyết định bỏ cách sử dụng các tips để hỗ trợ và thay vào đó tập trung nâng cao vốn từ vựng của mình, chính vì thế mà sách Boost là công cụ hỗ trợ tuyệt vời với mình (mình tự học và base hoàn toàn vào sách Boost)

Cách thức sử dụng:

- **Giai đoạn bắt đầu:** Mình làm từng passage một -> check đáp án -> tự sửa sai -> check lần nữa -> note lại lỗi sai của mình. Sau đó mình dùng các cây highlight để tô lên các từ vựng academic mình chưa biết, vừa tô vừa nhìn sang cột nghĩa/ synonym. Sau đó mình lại đọc lại lần nữa các từ vựng đó, học luôn các synonym bên cạnh. (Lời khuyên nhỏ là các bạn nên học synonym mà sách gợi ý vì sau này các bạn sẽ gặp cách paraphrase, các từ này rất nhiều lần ở các bài đọc khác)
- **Giai đoạn sau:** Khi có được một vốn từ khá, mình sẽ làm nguyên 1 test + check từ vựng mới và học thuộc.

Lưu ý nhỏ: Mình luôn ôn tập các từ vựng đã học mỗi ngày, nên mình nhớ được khá nhiều và lâu các academic words đó, điều này giúp mình làm được các bài test khó hơn.

- **Giai đoạn cuối:** Sau khi sử dụng xong bộ Boost của bộ Cam, mình có làm test ở cuốn The Official Cambridge Guide to Ielts + kết hợp phiên bản Boost của bộ này, từ vựng của bộ này khó hơn nhiều, có nhiều từ mới và tất nhiên mình học được rất nhiều thứ.

Bên cạnh đó mình còn có thói quen đọc lại các bài trong sách, đọc để hiểu, đến khi nào không biết từ vựng thì nhìn qua cột nghĩa + đánh dấu để học lại =)))

- **Thành quả:** Đến ngày đi thi thì bài đọc mình đọc hiểu gần như toàn bộ, có rất nhiều từ vựng mà mình gặp đều đã có trong sách nên mình làm khá suôn sẻ ạ.

Kết luận:

- Sách Boost đã cung cấp mình một "từ điển mini", tiết kiệm thời gian tra từ điển, đặc biệt là đưa lười như mình
- Có cột synonym -> học được nhiều từ hơn, giải quyết cách ra đề bằng paraphrase bằng synonym
- Phiên bản sách boost 11 có thêm các từ vựng gốc, giúp mình có thể dựa vào để đoán nghĩa
- Cái câu quote của thầy Đình Thắng cũng rất "motivate" mình nữa ^^

**Dau Hoang Thanh Luy**

21 tháng 8, 2020 · 🌐

...

[Boost your Vocabulary review]

Hì mọi người, mình là Thanh Luy, mình vừa thi IELTS ngày 6/8 và trong quá trình ôn luyện có sử dụng bộ sách Boost your vocabulary của anh Đình Thắng. Mình còn nhớ bài test reading đầu tiên của mình chỉ ở mức 5.5 lúc cuối tháng 3. Sau đó thì mình bắt đầu tự ôn reading theo bộ Vocab này, mỗi lần làm xong 1 test trong Cam, sửa bài xong mình lấy bộ Vocab ra học. Sau 3 tháng làm test và học xoay vòng bộ Vocab nhiều lần thì từ vựng của mình tăng lên đáng kể. Không những vậy khả năng đọc hiểu cũng tăng vì sau khi đọc lại nhiều lần thì mình cũng quen luôn với cấu trúc câu phức tạp.

Và cuối cùng sau 3 tháng học thì điểm Reading của mình tăng từ 5.5 lên 8.0. Mình nghĩ bộ Vocab này thực sự cần thiết cho các bạn ôn thi IELTS.

Nhân đây em cũng muốn cảm ơn anh Đình Thắng và nhóm biên tập đã bỏ công sức soạn bộ tài liệu hữu ích cho mọi người.

Menu



IELTS Academic

HOANG THANH LUY DAU, Thursday
6 August 2020

British Council Ho Chi Minh City

Reference: AC [REDACTED]

This test has been completed.

Results



Listening

8.0

Reading

8.0

Writing

6.5

**Trang Nguyễn**

26 Tháng 4, 2022 · 🌐

...

[Review hành trình tự học Reading và Writing từ 4.0 - 7.0]

Chào cả nhà, mình mới thi IELTS hôm 9/4 và đạt được kết quả như hình. Dù chưa phải là số điểm quá ấn tượng nhưng vẫn muốn review chút cho những bạn muốn tự học IELTS theo style những con khỉ họ đố => >.

Đôi lời về background của mh: Dù lên kế hoạch học t.a từ năm 1 nhưng tới tận năm 4 mới chịu lòi sách vở ra học. sau 1 năm thì mh đạt cở 4.0 Listening và Reading. Sau đó mình có học khóa Foundation và thêm 1 khóa về Writing với aim 6.0, vì vậy nếu nói cả hành trình tự học là giật tít cho mn đọc bài thôi 😊.

1. Phương châm học của mh:

- Practice makes perfect
- Chọn lọc 1 số ít tài liệu trong quá trình học, không save tài liệu về máy theo đam mê, không dùng tràn lan tránh mất thời gian mà còn kém hiệu quả, gây hoang mang lòng quân :))))

2. Reading skill:

- Mh chỉ học kết hợp bộ Cam và bộ Boost your vocabulary (thực ra là do mh lười và học không kịp. Mh được bạn bè rcm cuốn Trainer, mh chưa tìm nên không chắc lắm)
- Trước khi học, mh hiểu rõ mh làm reading k tốt là do vocab ít, dẫn tới k hiểu question, k hiểu nội dung của passage, và cũng khiến tốc độ đọc chậm nên làm test không kịp => Mình cố gắng tăng vocab
- Trước mỗi cuốn BYV cũng có hướng dẫn cách học nhưng mh học theo cách của mh thường dùng và cảm thấy hiệu quả hơn với bản thân. Thứ tự học của mình là: bấm đúng thời gian làm test và check xem đúng bn câu (chưa chữa bài nhé) --> mở cuốn BYV tương ứng xem vocab (trong bước này sẽ cố gắng đoán nghĩa của từ trước khi check từ điển) --> phân tích cấu trúc từng câu trong mỗi passage, xác định rõ những từ "it, they, those,..." xem nó là cái gì --> đọc lại bài rồi chữa test vừa làm (bước này mh sẽ tìm lại evidence cho tất cả các câu trả lời, tìm các cụm paraphrase giữa question và passage, lí giải vì sao lúc test làm sai). Bằng cách học này, mỗi passage mh sẽ đọc tối thiểu 3 lần. Tới lúc thi thì mh cũng chỉ mới đọc đc 4 cuốn BYV 8, 9, 11, 15. Mn cố gắng học nhiều hơn để "boost your vocab" nhé 😊
- Để đỡ chán và cũng dễ nhớ hơn thì mh chơi quizziz hằng ngày nữa.

🔊 Listening	6.0
📖 Reading	7.0
✍ Writing	7.0
🗣 Speaking	6.5
Overall	6.5



Bông Xù

23 Tháng 6, 2020 · 🌐

...

Xin chào Thầy và các bạn,

Hôm nay mình ở đây để chia sẻ cách học và ôn thi Reading của mình, với hi vọng có thể giúp một số bạn tìm được cách học phù hợp với bản thân.

Trước hết, xin giới thiệu một chút về việc học IELTS nói chung của bản thân. Mình bắt đầu học IELTS khi đã có nền tảng cơ bản về tiếng Anh, nên mình theo học khóa Overall của thầy Đinh Thắng từ tháng 12/2019 - tháng 4/2020 và tham gia kì thi IELTS ngày 6/6 vừa qua. Kết quả đạt được là overall 7.5 với điểm 8.5 Reading.

Thứ hai, về các kỹ năng khác, vì cách học của mình về cơ bản giống với chị Thanh Tâm đã chia sẻ ở bài viết trước đó (tụi mình cùng học Thầy, lại là partner học Writing và Speaking), nên nếu cần các bạn có thể tham khảo tại:

<https://www.facebook.com/groups/IELTSfamily/permalink/3059157100796693/>

Ngay từ khi bắt đầu học IELTS, mình đã xác định Reading và Listening sẽ là 2 kỹ năng chính mình tập trung ôn luyện, nên thứ tự ưu tiên khi học là Reading - Listening - Writing - Speaking. Về cách học và ôn thi Reading, mình chủ yếu sử dụng 2 bộ tài liệu là Boost your vocabulary (BYV) - IELTS Family và IELTS Trainer 1 (Trainer) - Cambridge. Hai bộ tài liệu này chỉ cần search trên Google là có đầy đủ.

1. CÁCH HỌC READING

1.1. Học từ vựng

Mình sử dụng BYV ngay từ đầu - tức là chưa làm thử test trong bộ CAM và mình đọc nó MỖI NGÀY, ít nhất là 1 test. Việc học từ vựng của mình chia làm 3 giai đoạn nối tiếp nhau.

* Phase 1: Mình đọc và highlight từ mới bằng màu vàng và đọc nghĩa ở cột bên phải. Sau khi đọc xong, mình đọc lại các từ đã highlight và nghĩa của nó.

* Phase 2: Mình đọc lại bài và thử tự đưa ra vài từ đồng nghĩa/trái nghĩa của các từ đã highlight. Đối với những từ không trả lời được hoặc chỉ đưa ra được 1 từ, mình highlight màu cam các từ đồng nghĩa/trái nghĩa. Sau khi đọc xong, lại quay xe =]]]]]]

* Phase 3: Mình đọc lại bài và khoanh những từ vẫn chưa nhớ nghĩa. Tiếp tục quay lại để học những từ này.

1.2. Đọc, đọc và đọc

Phần này đọc để duy trì thói quen đọc và để không bay hết từ đã học. Thông thường, mình đọc 1 test/ngày. Tuy nhiên, vào thời gian bận học ở trường, mình thay việc đọc BYV bằng đọc báo hoặc các tài liệu nghiên cứu.

Khi đọc, mình không chỉ chú trọng vào từ vựng nữa, mà xem xét cả cấu trúc câu để hiểu bài đọc.

2. CÁCH ÔN THI READING

Bên cạnh việc duy trì đọc, mình luyện thi Reading trong một tháng cuối. Mình nghĩ việc luyện đề quan trọng là tìm điểm yếu và luyện tốc độ làm bài, nên mình đã:

- Bấm giờ làm bài cho từng bài đọc hoặc đề. Thời điểm làm bài nên là buổi sáng, tương ứng với thời gian thi thật (cái này là kinh nghiệm xương máu của cô bạn thân của mình đấy =]]]]]]]]]
 - Khi làm đánh dấu lại những câu không chắc/làm bừa.
 - Sau khi làm kiểm tra kĩ đáp án những câu đánh dấu, câu sai để xem tại sao sai. Mình từng đọc một bài trong nhóm này, có anh chị bảo vấn đề là ở tư duy của mình khác với người bản xứ, nên có những câu tưởng đúng nhưng thực ra lại không phải thế.
 - Note lại lỗi sai và giải pháp. Từ này mình dựa theo mẫu trong Answer sheet cải tiến của thầy Đình Thắng, nhưng vì mình đã in hết AS từ hồi...năm 2 đại học (cùng cả chồng sách Cam với hi vọng sẽ học hành chăm chỉ và đi thi từ lúc đó, nhưng kết quả là cho tới lúc thi mình chỉ dùng mỗi tờ giấy trả lời =]]]]]]]]]) nên lúc bắt đầu học theo Boost mình gỡ lại và in tờ này thôi.
- Trải nghiệm cá nhân là làm bài mà không check lại đáp án và không lưu ý để sửa lỗi sai thì đừng làm cho khỏe, nhìn số lượng lỗi sai càng nản thêm =]]]]]]]

2.1. Học theo dạng bài

Mỗi tuần, có 3 ngày mình luyện bài - làm 2 passage/ngày, nhưng chỉ chọn những bài đọc có các dạng bài khó. Đối với mình, mình tập trung luyện T/F/NG và Y/N/NG, Matching information và Matching heading.

Sách luyện thi cũng không có sách cụ thể, bạn mình gửi cho vài bộ tài liệu - đều chỉ có đáp án chứ không giải thích gì thêm - nên mình chọn vài bài đọc theo nhu cầu để làm.

Không biết chỗ khác học thế nào, nhưng mình thấy rất tự hào về phương pháp làm Matching information của Thầy =]]]]]]] Và vì mình nghĩ đây là một trong những tinh hoa của khóa học, nên mình xin phép không chia sẻ kĩ cách học.

2.2. Luyện đề

Mỗi tuần mình luyện 1 đề trong Trainer. Trainer được đánh giá khó hơn CAM (nhưng tuyệt vời ở chỗ, nó giải thích rất kỹ đáp án), lúc luyện mình bị lỗi thời gian nên khi luyện bài hay luyện đề đều cố gắng đẩy nhanh tốc độ. Hai ngày cuối trước khi thi, mình vẫn bị thiếu 5 phút làm test 4.

Trên đây là bài chia sẻ của mình, mong rằng có thể tiếp sức cho các bạn đang trên con đường chinh phục tấm bằng IELTS. Chúc các bạn đạt được mục tiêu!

Nếu có thắc mắc gì, các bạn comment tại post này nhé, mình xin phép không trả lời inbox.

Nhân đây, em xin chân thành cảm ơn thầy Đình Thắng vì những kiến thức và sự hỗ trợ của thầy trong quá trình em theo học. Em cảm ơn các anh chị trong team IELTS Family vì bộ sách Boost your vocabulary, dự án 60s vocab, những bài đăng về từ vựng... đã giúp em có thêm kiến thức và sự tự tin khi tham dự kì thi. Cuối cùng, cảm ơn partner Thanh Tâm đã tiếp thêm động lực, cùng em kiên trì vượt qua thử thách này ❤️

Lấy sách Boost your vocabulary ở đâu?

Bạn có thể tìm các tài liệu FULL bộ sách Boost your vocabulary **MIỄN PHÍ** tại

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Hoặc

 **Group IELTS family - Các nhóm tự học IELTS**

 **Hội chia sẻ sách Boost your vocabulary**

Một số dự án liên quan:

1. 60s vocabulary: Học từ vựng bằng cách pha trộn giữa tiếng Anh và tiếng Việt trong các bài Reading của quyển Boost your Vocabulary.
2. Word root: Học từ vựng thông qua gốc từ, bằng cách này các bạn có thể học 1 gốc từ nhưng có thể biết và hiểu > 10 từ vựng khác.
3. Học từ vựng qua báo chí: Ôn luyện và hệ thống lại từ vựng đã và đang học trong các quyển Boost Your Vocabulary.

Từ 2017 đến nay, bộ sách vẫn đang được cung cấp hoàn toàn **MIỄN PHÍ**. Mong các bạn khi sử dụng bộ sách và đạt kết quả tốt, hãy thông báo lại cho A&M để cả team có động lực thực hiện nhiều dự án hữu ích cộng đồng hay hơn nữa bạn nhé.

Xin đừng im lặng!

Chân thành cảm ơn các bạn!
A&M team